POLICY PAPER / PAKISTAN

LEGISLATIVE INTELLIGENCE

and the Reconstitution of Legislative Power in Pakistan



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Evolutionary, Strategic and Anticipatory Legal Intelligence

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Executive summary

This paper recommends a bounded programme of legislative intelligence through existing parliamentary, governmental and professional services. Its purpose is to improve the means by which a representative institution identifies the law, examines alternatives and requires an account of implementation. It does not propose another central agency or assume that purchasing a digital system supplies legislative capacity.

The paper is addressed to legislators, committee and research services, responsible government departments and potential professional collaborators. The immediate decision is whether an authorised institution should select a narrow enquiry, appoint its own accountable research and review leads, and establish the sources, access and resources required to complete it. Participation by another institution requires its agreement.

Two enquiries give the method practical form. The banking-dispute dossier examines the Law and Justice Commission's alternative dispute resolution recommendation alongside the enacted housing-finance amendment. The Gazette establishes that Act XLVI of 2026 inserts section 15A, not the proposed section 10A; its separate settlement procedure must be considered before a further drafting instruction is settled. The digital enquiry examines how the Digital Economy Enhancement Project's financing and planned infrastructure and service arrangements can preserve lawful decisions, effective correction and institutional continuity after project finance ends.

The analysis reaches five principal findings. First, Pakistan already has substantial constitutional, procedural and institutional foundations. The concerned Division's policy responsibility, Law and Justice's advice and drafting, Parliamentary Affairs' business and follow-up functions, parliamentary scrutiny and assistance from the Pakistan Institute for Parliamentary Services must remain distinguishable. Coordination should improve the information available to each actor without making independent scrutiny dependent on executive agreement.

Second, provincial judgment cannot be reduced to a common federal workflow. Punjab, Sindh, Khyber Pakhtunkhwa and Balochistan have distinct preparation, advice, committee and transmission arrangements. Shared research and interoperable records can support those arrangements without transferring constitutional competence. The paper preserves the identified limits of the current provincial evidence.

Third, the stages of digital work matter. Digitisation, structured legislation, institutional mapping and executable rules require different evidence. Comparative registers show how provision-level reading, version history and enabling-law relationships can make that evidence usable. A decision model additionally requires a defined purpose, legal review and a boundary around discretion. The Pakistan Akoma Ntoso profile remains a draft with named dependencies distinct from the newer international standard. The maturity and scope of each Digital Nation Pakistan publication must be established separately; a technical format cannot determine authority for a substantive decision.

Fourth, the Digital Economy Enhancement Project's financing, procurement, financial opinions and implementation reports answer different questions. They provide a concrete basis for scrutinising responsibilities, safeguards and continuity, not a general assurance of completed delivery. The proposed continuity dossier would identify the service owner, data custodian, operator, recurrent means and responsibility for unresolved claims and remedies. The Digital Nation Pakistan

Act 2025, the financing and project agreements and the dated World Bank and audit records supply the legal and evidential basis for that enquiry.

Fifth, Evolutionary, Strategic and Anticipatory Legal Intelligence are co-central. The work must examine the evidence and authority for correction, purpose and lawful means, and foreseeable consequences and dependencies together. Faster retrieval alone is not the measure of success.

The first gate is a verified source sample, a baseline of present work and an identified reviewer responsible for the conclusion. Continuation depends on demonstrated use and sustainable review and maintenance. A material source or legal-status defect, inadequate protection of confidential information or absence of accountable review should hold back the affected work. A better-grounded decision includes a reasoned decision to narrow or discontinue the enquiry.

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Reader's guide: sources and status

The paper distinguishes existing law and institutional practice from its analytical and operational proposals. The accompanying source register identifies cited records, links, editions and material limits. These distinctions allow the reader to examine what each source establishes and what remains to be decided.

Table 1. Reading the record

Record	What the reader may take from it	Further question
Enacted instrument	The text and legal event established by the identified official record	Which version applies, and what commenced or changed?
Bill or draft	Wording proposed at the recorded stage	Was it amended, passed, assented to and commenced?
Debate or speech	What the identified speaker argued	What action followed, and what interpretive use is lawful?
Committee or law-reform report	Findings or recommendations within its stated remit	Were they adopted, implemented or otherwise acted upon?

Record	What the reader may take from it	Further question
Institutional account, research or commercial material	The activity, study or claim actually documented	How was it tested, and what does it leave unestablished?

A record's category does not settle every proposition drawn from it. The dossier should record three matters separately: **record status**, including jurisdiction, stage, version and commencement where material; **evidence position**, identifying inspected passages, reported material, missing records and inference; and **interpretive position**, identifying the reading advanced, any material competing reading and the review still required. An enacted text can have a disputed interpretation. A recommendation can have well-supported factual premises. A record not retrieved leaves a gap in this enquiry, not proof that the legal event did not occur. These descriptions preserve the reason for uncertainty rather than replace it with a confidence score.

Scope of the sources

The paper draws on the legal and institutional records identified in the notes and source register, with comparative publications examined through 31 October 2026. It distinguishes primary law, official institutional accounts, research, conceptual scholarship and its own proposals. The Digital Economy Enhancement Project findings preserve the gaps in acceptance evidence, management letters, provincial agreements and operational safeguards. The final Gazette of Act XLVI of 2026 has been examined and distinguished from the banking-dispute recommendation; that examination does not certify an exhaustive later amendment history. Footnotes supply authorities and pinpoints; the source register records links, editions and material limits.

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Names and technical terms

ADR	Alternative dispute resolution
AI	Artificial intelligence
AKN	Akoma Ntoso
AKN4EU	Akoma Ntoso profile for European Union legal documents
BOI	Board of Investment
DCAT	Data Catalog Vocabulary
DEEP	Digital Economy Enhancement Project
DNP	Digital Nation Pakistan
DRS	Document Retrieval System
ECLI	European Case Law Identifier
ELI	European Legislation Identifier
EU	European Union
GPO	United States Government Publishing Office
HTML	Hypertext Markup Language
IDA	International Development Association
IETF	Internet Engineering Task Force
IPU	Inter-Parliamentary Union
ISR	Implementation Status and Results Report
LJCP	Law and Justice Commission of Pakistan
MoITT	Ministry of Information Technology and Telecommunication
NADRA	National Database and Registration Authority
NDC	National Digital Commission
NITB	National Information Technology Board
OASIS	Organization for the Advancement of Structured Information Standards
OECD	Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development
PDA	Pakistan Digital Authority
PDF/UA	PDF Universal Accessibility
PIPS	Pakistan Institute for Parliamentary Services
PKR	Pakistani rupees
PROV-O	PROV Ontology
PVARA	Pakistan Virtual Assets Regulatory Authority
RFC	Request for Comments
SBP	State Bank of Pakistan
SECP	Securities and Exchange Commission of Pakistan
SGA&CD	Services, General Administration and Coordination Department
SKOS	Simple Knowledge Organization System

SRO	Statutory Regulatory Order
UNDP	United Nations Development Programme
URN	Uniform Resource Name
USLM	United States Legislative Markup
WCAG	Web Content Accessibility Guidelines
XML	Extensible Markup Language

Publication names and classifiers

FWK — Framework publication

PRF — Profile publication

RA — Reference architecture

STD — Standard publication

WASL — Pakistan National Data Exchange Layer

LEOS — Legislation editor named in the cited European Commission material

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Table of legislation

Page references identify where the cited provisions are discussed in this paper.

Pakistan Federal

Constitution of the Islamic Republic of Pakistan 1973

14th edn, as amended to 21 November 2025

arts 50, 67, 70, 73, 87–88 and 239. Parliament, procedure, legislative routes and institutional resources	16
art 99. Federal allocation and transaction of business	16
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arts 48, 54, 75, 77, 80–84, 89. Presidential action, assent, financial powers and Ordinances	20
arts 57, 100(3). Attorney-General advice and parliamentary participation	20

Digital Nation Pakistan Act 2025 (Act I of 2025)

Gazette of Pakistan, Extraordinary, 29 January 2025

ss 5(a), 8(a)–(h) and 11. Masterplan approval, PDA functions and retained institutional responsibility	46
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Federal Board of Revenue Act 2007 (Act IV of 2007)

Pakistan Code text

ss 3 and 4(1)(a), (c). Establishment and tax-administration functions	47

Pakistan Institute for Parliamentary Services Act 2008 (Act III of 2008)

PIPS-hosted consolidation updated to 23 September 2021

s 4. Research, technical assistance, training, records and committee support	17

Securities and Exchange Commission of Pakistan Act 1997 (Act XLII of 1997)

Pakistan Code text

ss 3 and 20(4)(a)–(b). Establishment; securities issue and markets	47

State Bank of Pakistan Act 1956 (Act XXXIII of 1956)

s 4C inserted by Act VI of 2022, Gazette of Pakistan, Extraordinary, 29 January 2022

s 4C(g)–(h). Payment systems; licensing and supervision of banks	47

Virtual Assets Act 2026 (Act XIII of 2026)

Pakistan Code text; replaced the lapsed Virtual Assets Ordinance 2025 (Ordinance VII of 2025)

ss 5(2)–(3), 6, 7(1), 17(1) and 74. Primary vesting, composition, inter-agency cooperation, deference to data-protection law and savings	47

Rules of Business 1973

Cabinet Division compilation amended to 28 September 2026

r 1(3); SRO 687(I)/2026 (24 April 2026). Application to digitalised government business	17
rr 2(1)(xiii), 3–6, 8, 14 and 16. Allocation, policy responsibility, ministerial direction and official responsibility	16
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Rules of Procedure and Conduct of Business in the National Assembly 2007

Official compilation modified to 18 August 2026

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Rules of Procedure and Conduct of Business in the Senate 2012

Official compilation amended to 6 June 2026

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Parliament (Joint Sittings) Rules 1973

Available National Assembly text retains historical wording in rr 10–11; not a harmonised current consolidation

rr 10–11. Second-House and joint-sitting route	19

Auditor-General's (Functions, Powers and Terms and Conditions of Service) Ordinance 2001 (Ordinance XXIII of 2001)

Pakistan Code text

ss 8(d) and 14. Audit of federally established bodies and audit powers	47

Law and Justice Commission of Pakistan Ordinance 1979

LJCP-hosted consolidation updated to 12 November 2021; subsequent amendment completeness not certified

ss 5(3), 6(1), 6(5), 6-C, 6-D, 8. Law reform, research and legislative recommendations	21

National Database and Registration Authority Ordinance 2000 (Ordinance VIII of 2000)

Pakistan Code text

ss 3 and 5(1), (4)(c)–(d). Establishment, databases and data confidentiality	47

Punjab

Provincial Assembly of the Punjab Rules of Procedure 1997

Official compilation amended to June 2025

General reference. Institutional allocation and executive business	27
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Sindh

Sindh Government Rules of Business 1986

Compilation amended to 13 March 2024, read with the reviewed later amendments through 9 October 2026

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r 38, especially sub-r (v). Law vetting and control of subsequent changes	28, 28
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Substitution of the Schedule II Inter-Provincial Coordination allocation

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Rules of Procedure of the Provincial Assembly of Sindh 2013

Official Assembly compilation; later amendment cut-off not verified

rr 99–114. Committee reference, intervals, consideration and amendments	28
rr 116–118. Transmission, publication and return	28
r 167, especially sub-r (7). Departmental oversight and response to recommendations	28

Khyber Pakhtunkhwa

Khyber Pakhtunkhwa Assembly Procedure and Conduct of Business Rules 2025

Official text; preface dates changes to 10 September 2025

rr 111 and 113–116. Publication, reference and consideration intervals	29
rr 132–134. Transmission, publication and deemed-return reconsideration	29
rr 184–188. Committee expert assistance and legal participation	29
r 318. Replacement of the earlier rules and savings	29

Khyber Pakhtunkhwa Government Rules of Business 1985

Official KP Code compilation; comprehensive amendment cut-off not verified

rr 4–5 and sch II. Departmental responsibilities and allocation	29
rr 11 and 12(3), (5)–(7). Financial consultation, legal advice and disagreement	29
r 19(2). Cabinet-reference exception; constitutional application reserved	30
r 29(5), (7). Passed-Bill processing and publication	29

Balochistan

Balochistan Government Rules of Business 2012

Official consolidation modified to 29 July 2026

r 15, especially sub-rr (3)–(4). Finance consultation, escalation and Cabinet condition	30
rr 17(3)–(9) and 24. Law consultation and executive preparation	29
r 25. Cabinet-reference exception; constitutional application reserved	30
r 38(1)–(3). Originating-department handoff and publication	29, 30
r 38(7)–(11). Transmission, assent processing and publication	30

Balochistan Assembly Rules of Procedure and Conduct of Business 1974

Official compilation amended to 22 December 2025

rr 81–85. Publication, Finance Bill procedure, reference and consideration	30
rr 99–100, especially r 100(2) proviso and (6). Transmission, publication and reconsideration	30
rr 128–129, especially rr 128(2) and 129(3). Committee allocation and expert assistance	30

Identified and proposed instruments

The following records have the qualifications stated below; identification or proposal is not treated as verification of operative text.

Financial Institutions (Recovery of Finances) Ordinance 2001

The existing parent text requires current-law verification; s 10A is cited as an LJCP proposal, not enacted law

Proposed s 10A; s 15A discussed through the separate amendment report. Parent statute and separate ADR and housing-finance tracks	41, 41, 44, 46

Financial Institutions (Recovery of Finances) (Amendment) Bill 2026 and recorded Act XLVI of 2026

Committee report, Senate registers and final Gazette examined; Act XLVI of 2026 concerns housing finance and does not insert proposed section 10A

Sections 1–4 examined. Enacted housing-finance provisions distinguished from proposed section 10A	41

SO(Cab-I)2-47/82.V-II(P), 20 August 2025

Identified in an official Lahore High Court research bulletin only

Operative provisions not retrieved. Outstanding executive-allocation amendment locator 27

SO(CAB-I)2-47/85(VOL-II), 1 December 2025

Identified in an official Lahore High Court research bulletin only

Operative provisions not retrieved. Outstanding executive-allocation amendment locator 27

SO(CAB-I)2-2/2001(P), 29 April 2026

Identified in an official Lahore High Court research bulletin only

Operative provisions not retrieved. Outstanding executive-allocation amendment locator 27

SO(CAB-I)2-4/2026(AMA), 1 August 2026

Identified in an official Lahore High Court research bulletin only

Operative provisions not retrieved. Outstanding executive-allocation amendment locator 27

Personal Data Protection Bill (Ministry of Information Technology and Telecommunication draft, May 2023)

Draft only; not enacted. A 2023 private member's Bill stands withdrawn from Senate committee. No data-protection authority has been established

Draft status only. Proposed data-protection commission not established 47

Assemblée nationale, amendement no 2424 au projet de loi de financement de la sécurité sociale pour 2026, texte no 1907 (1 November 2025)

Withdrawn proposal, not enacted legislation

Filed amendment; pp 1, 3–4 cited. Use of LexImpact estimates in a subsequently withdrawn amendment 33

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Project agreements and financial instruments

Islamic Republic of Pakistan and International Development Association, Financing Agreement: Digital Economy Enhancement Project (Credit 7514-PK, 2024)

art II, ss 2.01 and 2.08. Credit denomination and closing date 48

sch 2, implementation arrangements, including section I.A.9–10. Implementation responsibility, data protection and provincial arrangements 48

International Development Association and National Database and Registration Authority, Project Agreement: Digital Economy Enhancement Project (April 2024)

art III, s 3.01 and schedule. NADRA implementation obligations and institutional continuity 48

International Development Association, *Digital Economy Enhancement Project: Disbursement and Financial Information Letter* (1 April 2024)

Disbursement and financial reporting arrangements. Financial administration of the credit 48

01 / THE ENQUIRY

Legislative power and the means of exercising it

Parliament may possess the power to make law and remain dependent upon the executive for the information by which a Bill can be examined. A committee may be entitled to obtain evidence and receive it too late to affect the decision. A member may have a route for introducing an amendment and lack the drafting assistance needed to give it legal form. The authority exists in each case. The means of exercising it are incomplete.

This is the problem from which legislative intelligence must begin. A legislature requires more than a supply of documents. It needs to know which text governs, what a proposal would change, whose authority would increase, what resources its implementation would require, and how those affected could question the result. Information becomes a source of legislative capacity when members can use it to examine and alter a proposal, rather than merely receive an explanation of a decision already settled elsewhere.

Authority and the means of exercising it are therefore distinct questions. Articles 50, 67 and 87–88 establish Parliament's composition, each House's control of its own procedure, and the Houses' separate secretariats and control of their expenditure; the National Assembly's rules confer committee powers of examination and evidence; and the Pakistan Institute for Parliamentary Services Act 2008 provides statutory research and committee support (see notes 1, 6 and 7). None of these provisions ensures that the information, drafting assistance or time needed to use those powers will be available. This paper accordingly distinguishes two kinds of defect. An unlawful substitution of the decision-maker calls for enforcement of the lawful allocation. A disabling dependence upon another institution may instead require capacity, procedure or resources to be changed. Another law is not the answer to every failure; nor does compliance with existing law place an arrangement beyond reconsideration.

Legislative intelligence should make these differences examinable. It should connect the relevant legal text to the institution entitled to act, the reasons for and against a proposal, its practical means and the consequences of its operation. The resulting analysis must be available while a choice remains open. Advice delivered after passage may explain what happened; it cannot supply the opportunity for scrutiny which was missing before it.

This paper is an independent enquiry into how that capacity can be built. The banking-dispute dossier developed below tests the approach against an actual reform recommendation. It asks what should be decided, by whom, upon which evidence and with what provision for what follows. Its conclusions are offered for examination by the institutions concerned, whose advice, procedure and decisions remain their own.

02 / THE ENQUIRY

Three dimensions of the enquiry

Evolutionary, Strategic and Anticipatory Legal Intelligence are co-central dimensions of the approach. Each addresses a question which the others cannot settle alone. A proposal may work under its initial conditions and possess no adequate means of correction when those conditions change. It may pursue a defensible purpose and fail because the institution cannot carry it out. It may be capable of immediate operation and impose consequences which were never examined.

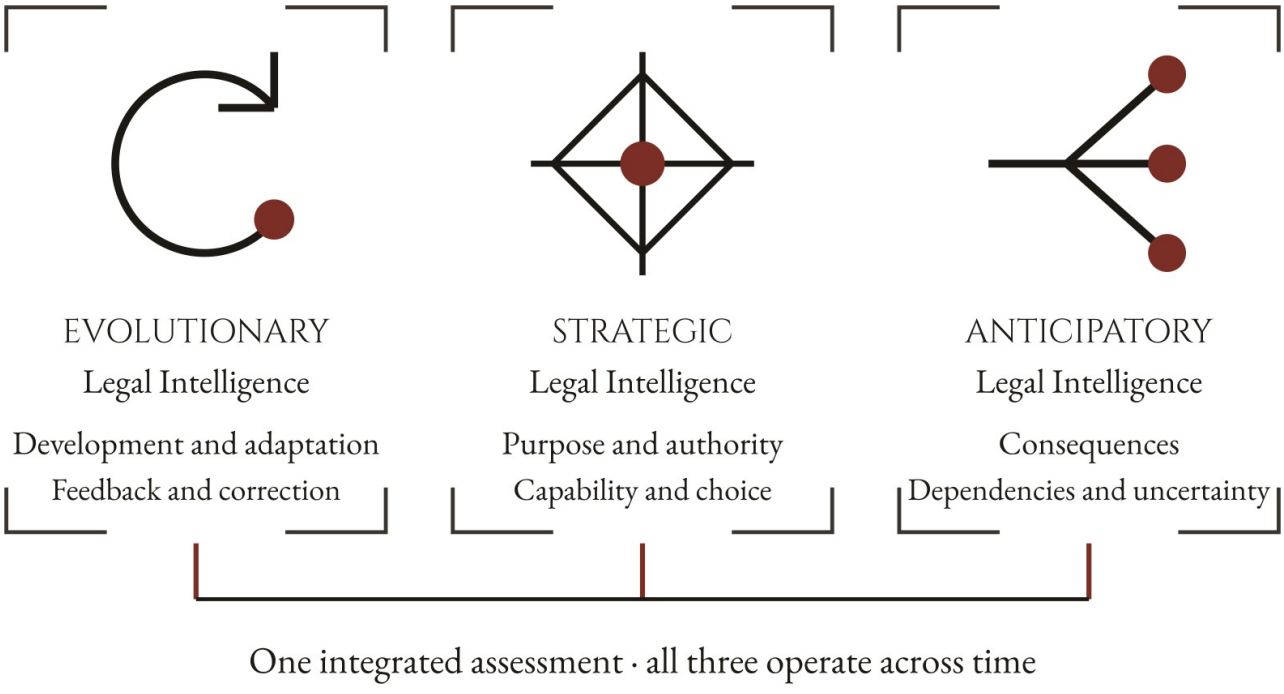


Figure 1. Evolutionary, Strategic and Anticipatory Legal Intelligence are co-central dimensions of one enquiry, operating together across time.

Evolutionary Legal Intelligence examines development and correction. The history of a provision may explain the problem it was intended to answer and the arrangements it displaced. The proposed measure must also provide for its own future: the evidence by which implementation will be judged, the authority capable of correcting a failure, and the treatment of powers or concessions whose justification has expired.

Strategic Legal Intelligence examines the relationship between purpose, authority, capacity and choice. Who can act, by which instrument, with whose cooperation and through which resources? The enquiry should establish whether legislation is needed at all. Where an existing power is sufficient, the material question may concern its exercise; where the power is defective, better administration alone will leave the defect in place.

Anticipatory Legal Intelligence examines the consequences and dependencies of the available choices. A proposal rests upon assumptions about institutions, resources, conduct and the circumstances in which it will operate. Those assumptions can be tested against delayed appropriations, unavailable staff, litigation, technological change or unequal ability to bear a burden. The purpose is to identify which choices remain defensible under uncertainty and which require a safeguard, a different design or further evidence.

All three operate across time. Their connection should appear in one reasoned assessment of the capacity for revision, purpose, lawful means and consequences. These descriptions state the method used in this paper; the particular procedures that follow are proposals of this paper, applying that method to the constitutional and procedural allocations examined in sections 3 and 4.

The assessment should leave the reader able to identify the preferred course, the strongest reasonable alternative and the evidence which would change the conclusion. An enquiry that identifies no consequential question beyond the documents already available has not yet shown how it enlarges legislative judgment.

03 / THE ENQUIRY

The foundations already present in Pakistan

The Constitution provides a starting point from which practical reform can proceed. Parliament's composition, the Houses' authority over procedure, separate secretariats and control of expenditure within authorised appropriations are established legal arrangements. Ordinary Bills, Money Bills and constitutional amendments follow different routes. Provincial competence and procedure require their own examination. Articles 50, 67, 70, 73, 87–88, 127, 142 and 239 locate these questions within the constitutional order.[1]

The route affects who can participate in the decision. Expenditure consequences do not automatically make a proposal a Money Bill, and national importance does not establish exclusive federal competence. A legislative enquiry must therefore identify the jurisdiction, lawful decision-maker and appropriate instrument before recommending a change. An attractive policy objective cannot supply an authority which the Constitution allocates elsewhere.

Federal legislative preparation extends beyond the drafting of a Bill. The Rules of Business distribute policy responsibility to the concerned Division and its Minister-in-charge, legal advice and drafting to the Law and Justice Division, and parliamentary liaison and the priority of official business to Parliamentary Affairs. Rule 18(5) requires draft Bills, Ordinances and Orders to reach Cabinet after Law and Justice scrutiny, and changes to be made in consultation with that Division. The Secretary is the official head of the Division; the Minister directs its business and bears the relevant political responsibility. Those offices should remain distinguishable. A reference to "the Ministry" cannot settle whether a particular duty belongs to the Minister, Secretary or another institution.[2]

Parliamentary Affairs operates before, during and after consideration by the Houses. Divisions furnish their proposed business before a session. The Secretary, Parliamentary Affairs, prepares the provisional forecast and proposals for allocation of days through the appropriate Leader of the House, or the Prime Minister for a joint sitting, and prepares official-day business in the prescribed consultation. The final arrangement remains subject to the Speaker or Chairman. In the National Assembly, the Ministry supplies the annual session calendar and the Minister for Parliamentary Affairs intimates the order of government business to the Assembly Secretary. These are substantial responsibilities for preparation and priority. They coexist with private members' precedence, the Speaker's procedural authority and the Business Advisory Committee's role in recommending time.[3]

The same allocation continues after a statement is made in the House. The concerned Division must fulfil undertakings given in answers to questions; Parliamentary Affairs follows up governmental assurances, promises and undertakings; the National Assembly's Government Assurances Committee scrutinises implementation and timeliness. The Minister for Parliamentary Affairs is an ex officio member of that committee and of the Committee on Rules of Procedure and Privileges. Membership connects the executive to scrutiny without making its account the committee's conclusion.[4]

[1] Constitution of the Islamic Republic of Pakistan 1973, arts 50, 67, 70, 73, 87–88, 127, 142 and 239.

[2] Constitution of the Islamic Republic of Pakistan 1973, art 99; Rules of Business 1973, rr 2(1)(xiii), 3–6, 8, 14, 16, 18(5), 27–29 and 31–45, sch II entries 21 and 28, including r 27(1) proviso and r 27(5A).

[3] Rules of Business 1973 rr 32–38 and sch II entry 28(1)–(3); Rules of Procedure and Conduct of Business in the National Assembly 2007, rr 46, 51–52, 57 and 212–213.

[4] Rules of Business 1973 r 45(3) and sch II entry 28(4); Rules of Procedure and Conduct of Business in the National Assembly 2007, rr 206 and 210–211.

A legislative-intelligence programme which omits these functions would leave an important institutional relationship unexamined. A proposal can be legally prepared and still lack a place among government priorities. A question can receive a ministerial answer without the undertaking being fulfilled. Parliamentary Affairs is therefore an essential participant in a governmental programme linking preparation, business and follow-up. The parliamentary service must, at the same time, retain the means to examine the government's account independently. Coordination and scrutiny require connected records, with responsibility for each preserved.

Digitisation does not create another allocation. Rule 1(3), inserted in April 2026, applies the Rules of Business, with the necessary modifications, to business conducted through automated or digitalised applications, platforms or systems.[5] Consultation, approval and the prescribed parliamentary route remain questions of lawful authority when the record becomes digital. A change in the medium should make the responsible act more traceable, rather than conceal the institution which must perform it.

The National Assembly's own rules supply the means of legislative scrutiny. Rule 122 governs committee referral and its exceptions. Rule 201 provides for examination and recommendations, including constitutional scrutiny and specified ministerial response duties; rule 227 provides evidence-gathering powers and safeguards for disputed disclosure.[6] The executive's desired motion remains subject to the applicable House procedure. Whether a committee obtains the information it needs, early enough and in usable form, is a question about the exercise and adequacy of its powers. Describing those powers as absent would misidentify the reform required.

The Pakistan Institute for Parliamentary Services supplies another existing route. Its statutory functions include research, technical assistance, training, legislative records and committee support.[7] This paper therefore proposes strengthening and connecting existing services before adding another institution. Timely analysis, impartial access and protection of professional advice are the tests of the relationship, whatever organisational form supplies them.

From policy choice to an authorised Bill

A federal Government Bill should be followed through a complete sequence, not treated as a document which moves from a ministry to Parliament once Law has drafted it. The responsible Division determines the proposed content and consults affected Divisions, including Finance where necessary. Cabinet normally approves the issues before Law and Justice is asked to draft. Law then translates the instructions into provisions and advises on legislative competence and introduction requirements. The Division subsequently obtains approval of the draft and outstanding issues, the prescribed Prime Ministerial approval and any required consent or sanction. The initial exception for verbal or formal amendments does not waive every later requirement; Cabinet may expressly dispense with draft resubmission under rule 27(5A). Private members' proposals remain distinct: executive assessment under rule 28 addresses their implications and the Government's response; it is not government authorship or a freestanding power to bar introduction.[8]

These are different decisions. An intelligence record

[5] Rules of Business 1973 r 1(3), inserted by SRO 687(I)/2026 (24 April 2026).

[6] Rules of Procedure and Conduct of Business in the National Assembly 2007, rr 122, 201 and 227; Rules of Business 1973 rr 31 and 41.

[7] Pakistan Institute for Parliamentary Services Act 2008 (Act III of 2008), s 4.

[8] Rules of Business 1973, rr 8, 12, 16, 27(1)–(5A) and 28.

should preserve the problem, options, approved policy, drafting instructions, legal objections and approved text separately. It should reveal a change in policy disguised as a drafting alteration, and a drafting consequence which requires the policy to be reconsidered. The Minister's signed statement of objects and reasons accompanies the final text returned to Law. Under rule 27(8), Law checks introduction requirements and transfers the package to Parliamentary Affairs. That transfer changes responsibility for arranging introduction; it does not extinguish Law's advisory function.[9]

Law can enter before formal drafting through advice on legal questions and interpretation. Its scrutiny precedes Cabinet submission of draft Bills, Ordinances and Orders, and subsequent changes require consultation under rule 18(5). After introduction, National Assembly rules permit the Law Secretary or a nominee of at least Joint Secretary rank to attend the relevant committee. Constitutionally required amendment-consent questions are routed through Parliamentary Affairs and Law; executive amendment work also engages rule 29. These provisions do not give Law a veto over House amendments or replace the committee's own constitutional examination.[10]

The proposed record should therefore show each return for legal advice, the question asked, the version considered and the disposition of the answer. After enactment, statutory instruments and interpretation can require renewed consultation. A legislative cycle ends neither with transfer to Parliamentary Affairs nor with an Act's publication: implementation, delegated instruments, disputes and evidence of results can expose defects requiring another properly authorised enquiry.

Prime Minister, Cabinet and the Prime Minister's Office

The Prime Minister's constitutional executive position, Cabinet's collective role and the administrative support of the Prime Minister's Office must not be merged. Articles 90 and 91 locate executive authority and Cabinet responsibility; the Rules of Business prescribe Cabinet submission and decision methods. Cabinet committee decisions require ratification unless Cabinet has authorised otherwise. The Prime Minister's Office receives specified records and information, including records of orally obtained orders and parliamentary arrangements. Receipt by that Office is not itself a substitute for the competent Prime Ministerial, Cabinet or parliamentary act.[11]

A proposed coordination service should identify whose decision is outstanding and under which provision. It may track consultation, unresolved differences, approved changes and implementation commitments, but should not label every communication from the Prime Minister's Office "Cabinet approval". Separate recording protects both responsibility and candour: the Secretary's assessment, Minister's recommendation, legal advice and ultimate executive decision need not be identical. Parliamentary access remains governed by its own lawful arrangements, not by an executive system's permission settings.

Two Houses, distinct legislative routes and presidential action

Introduction, publication, committee examination, consideration, amendment and passage are separate parliamentary acts. National Assembly rules provide the default committee route and its exceptions, evidence-based scrutiny and the subsequent

[9] Rules of Business 1973, r 27(5)–(8).

[10] Rules of Business 1973, rr 14(1), 18(5) and 29; Rules of Procedure and Conduct of Business in the National Assembly 2007, rr 129(2), 200(4) and 201.

[11] Constitution of Pakistan 1973, arts 90–91; Rules of Business 1973, rr 15(4), 17–18 and 37. The specified Prime Minister's Office interfaces do not constitute an exhaustive description of its administrative functions.

consideration and passage stages. They also regulate Bills arriving from the Senate and National Assembly Bills returned with Senate amendments. An executive timetable cannot erase those stages. A proposed scrutiny service should supply clause comparisons, evidence and reasons for amendments under the receiving House's control, rather than present a government-approved text as the only permissible option.[12]

The Senate's own route requires a distinct record. Rule 96 requires the Minister's notice, Bill, signed statement of objects and reasons and Money Bill certificate; an amending Bill must include a comparison with the existing provisions. Rule 98 ordinarily refers an introduced Bill to the standing committee, subject to the Senate's dispensation and public-opinion procedures. Rule 99's consideration interval is normally two clear days after supplying copies, with specified exceptions and an urgency route. Bills received from the National Assembly instead engage rules 118–125: circulation, notice, consideration and possible committee reference by motion. Rule 120 ordinarily measures two working days from receipt of notice, unless the Chairman directs otherwise. These are different triggers, not an interchangeable waiting period.

The proposed dossier should preserve the comparison required for amendment, the actual referral or dispensation, committee changes and each House's text and message. Senate rules 104–117 address clause consideration, amendments, passage and transmission; rules 126–129 govern returned Bills, joint-sitting referral, authentication, assent submission and publication. The relevant Senate or National Assembly record must establish what happened. An executive transmission entry or a generic "passed" status cannot establish agreement on identical wording, a valid request for a joint sitting, assent or commencement.[13]

For an ordinary Bill, either House may originate within the constitutional route. Agreement on the text leads to presentation for assent. If the other House rejects it, does not pass it within 90 days of its being laid there, or the originating House does not pass the amended text, the originating House may request a joint sitting. The request is a House decision, not an automatic action on day 90. The current constitutional majority is that of members present and voting. Inconsistent historical wording in subordinate joint-sitting rules must not be converted into an automated voting threshold.[14]

A Money Bill originates only in the National Assembly. The Senate receives a copy simultaneously and may recommend within 14 days; the Assembly considers those recommendations but may pass the Bill without incorporating them. Classification and certification belong to the Speaker under Article 73. Article 74's consent requirements must be assessed separately, including where a financial measure is not a Money Bill. A constitutional amendment instead requires two-thirds of total membership in each House, with that threshold again in the originating House for an amended text. Altering provincial limits additionally requires the affected Provincial Assembly's approval by two-thirds of its total membership. Ordinary deadlock machinery cannot substitute for these requirements.[15]

The President's summoning function and assent function also require separate records. Article 75 provides ten days at first presentation and permits

[12] Rules of Procedure and Conduct of Business in the National Assembly 2007, rr 120–140, 144–155, 200–201 and 235.

[13] Rules of Procedure and Conduct of Business in the Senate 2012, rr 96, 98–99 and 104–129.

[14] Constitution of Pakistan 1973, arts 70 and 72(4); Parliament (Joint Sittings) Rules 1973, rr 10–11. The available joint-sitting text retains historical wording inconsistent with the current constitutional provisions; the Constitution controls.

[15] Constitution of Pakistan 1973, arts 73–74 and 239; Rules of Procedure and Conduct of Business in the National Assembly 2007, rr 141–143 and 156.

return of a non-Money Bill with a message. Reconsideration and repassage at a joint sitting lead to a further ten-day period, after which the specified deemed-assent consequence applies. That second-stage provision must not be treated as first-presentation deemed assent. The constitutional advice framework also remains applicable. Assent, Gazette publication and commencement are different events; commencement must be established from the particular enactment and any required instrument. Budget authorisation and the exceptional ordinance route likewise need their own constitutional analysis, not absorption into an ordinary Bill checklist.[16]

Attorney-General: advice, performance and institutional learning

The Attorney-General advises on legal matters referred or assigned by the Federal Government and has the constitutional right of audience. This office is not the ordinary drafting service for every Bill. Divisions normally consult it through Law and Justice, subject to the express arbitration-settlement exception. Disagreement is escalated through the Law Minister to the Prime Minister, who may refer the matter to Cabinet. That process determines the executive's course; it does not make executive preference binding constitutional interpretation or create an Attorney-General's veto. Article 57 permits parliamentary participation, including in a committee of which the Attorney-General is named a member, without a vote by virtue of that article—not automatic membership of every committee.[17]

Present performance must be distinguished from this mandate. The office's institutional account describes advice, litigation and referred legislative work, but is not an evaluated record of coverage, timeliness or quality. A Senate committee account of September 2026 records pending steps concerning law officers' remuneration and requests implementation reporting. It evidences an administrative issue under scrutiny, not completion of reform or deficient legal advice. These materials do not establish that legislative review is uniformly effective, uniformly inadequate or exclusively reactive.[18]

The proposed improvement is a risk-based referral and response record, not compulsory Attorney-General clearance of every proposal. A referral should identify competence, rights, procedural prerequisites, relevant litigation, alternative formulations and urgency. Law and the responsible Division should record their response, including unresolved objections and the competent decision-maker's reasons. Counsel-verified litigation feedback should distinguish a party's argument, interim order, final holding, appeal and compliance obligation before suggesting reform.

Evaluation requires authorised access to actual referrals, completion dates, complexity, staffing, unresolved objections and follow-through. Useful measures include advice received before irreversible commitments, missed deadlines, recurring avoidable procedural defects and timely implementation of judgments. Raw win rates can reward unsuitable litigation and discourage unwelcome but correct advice. Public reporting should use lawful aggregation or redaction. Software may retrieve authorities and flag deadlines; it must not issue the Attorney-General's opinion,

[16] Constitution of Pakistan 1973, arts 48, 54, 75, 77, 80–84 and 89; Rules of Business 1973, rr 42–42A.

[17] Constitution of Pakistan 1973, arts 57 and 100(3); Rules of Business 1973, rr 14(2)–(4) and 27, sch II entry 21. Parliamentary participation does not displace the limits stated in Article 57.

[18] Attorney-General for Pakistan, institutional account of functions (accessed 30 October 2026); Senate of Pakistan, 'Senate Committee Reviews Functioning of Special Courts and Tribunals, Juvenile Justice Amendments' (7 September 2026), discussion of law officers' remuneration and implementation reporting. The institutional description is not controlling constitutional text or an evaluated performance record.

waive privilege, concede a case or authorise settlement.

Law reform and digital-programme interfaces

The Law and Justice Commission of Pakistan provides a continuing reform interface. Its Ordinance requires systematic review and recommendations on modernisation, anomalies, obsolete provisions, simplification, codification and related reform; governments may refer matters within its functions. Research, committees and reporting support that work. Recommendations do not enact themselves or establish a universal clearance requirement for Bills.[19] A proposed reform register should connect diagnosed defects to options, recommendations, governmental responses and subsequent results. The sponsoring Division would remain responsible for its proposal; Parliament would retain its independent examination. Repeated litigation may identify a reform question without deciding its answer.

The digital programme requires a separate, connected record. The National Digital Commission, chaired by the Prime Minister, approves the Masterplan and implementation plans. The Pakistan Digital Authority reviews relevant digital projects, advises the Information Technology and Telecommunications Division on alignment and collaborates with legislative and regulatory bodies. The statutory Oversight Committee reviews the Pakistan Digital Authority's performance and reporting; it does not scrutinise every Bill. Applicable consultation, approval and monitoring provisions concern their specified objects.[20]

A legislative-intelligence service could seek programme support within those powers. It should record the applicable plan, direction and approval rather than infer authorisation from an institutional announcement. Programme approval cannot replace legislative authority, Cabinet procedure or parliamentary judgment, and technical cooperation should preserve institutional custody, lawful access and correction.

[19] Law and Justice Commission of Pakistan Ordinance 1979, ss 5(3), 6(1), 6(5), 6-C, 6-D and 8.

[20] Digital Nation Pakistan Act 2025, ss 2(pa), 3–5, 8(e)–(f), 9–12. The approval and consultation duties concern the objects specified in those provisions, not a universal legislative-clearance process.

FEDERAL INSTITUTIONAL RELATIONSHIPS

Typed links, not a single chain of command

President

Constitutional office
Advice and Bill functions differ.

Advice

Prime Minister

Cabinet

Prime Minister heads collective Cabinet.

Parliament comprises President, National Assembly and Senate.

Constitution Article 50: composition is not management authority.

Prime Minister's Office

Administrative support to the Prime Minister; not a substitute for Cabinet.

Cabinet Division / Secretary

Cabinet process, records and implementation coordination.

EXECUTIVE PREPARATION

Minister / Division → consultation, policy and draft decisions

Law: drafting / legal readiness; Finance: financial consultation

Cabinet: policy and draft approvals; prescribed exceptions apply

Law → Parliamentary Affairs → Minister introduces

Handoff, not control

National Assembly

Speaker · Secretariat · committees
Own procedure and scrutiny
Constitution Articles 67, 87

Senate

Chairman · Secretariat · committees
Own procedure and scrutiny
Constitution Articles 67, 87

Cabinet → both Houses: collective responsibility (Article 91(6)).

House-approved text → President: assent / return (Article 75).

Ordinary, Money Bill and constitutional-amendment routes differ.

Figure 2. Federal institutional relationships: constitutional functions, executive preparation and House scrutiny remain distinct.
Sources: Constitution of Pakistan 1973 and Rules of Business 1973; see notes 1–16.

BOUNDED INSTITUTIONAL INTERFACES

Advice, research and programme governance remain distinct

Attorney-General → Government / Houses

Legal advice and assigned duties; ordinary executive consultation through Law. Parliamentary participation as prescribed, without a vote by virtue of office. Not a general Bill-clearance gate.

Constitution Articles 57, 100; Rules of Business, rule 14(2)–(3)

Law and Justice Commission of Pakistan
→ Federal and Provincial Governments

Law-reform research, recommendations and advice on reference.
Not compulsory approval of every Bill. Ordinance 1979, section 6.

Pakistan Institute for Parliamentary Services
→ Parliamentary services

Research, technical assistance, training, legislative records and committee support.
Pakistan Institute for Parliamentary Services Act 2008, section 4; not a legislative chamber.

SEPARATE DIGITAL-PROGRAMME TRACK

Pakistan Digital Authority
→ National Digital Commission

Masterplan preparation and recommendations
Digital Nation Act, section 11

National Digital Commission
→ programme

Prime Minister chairs; Masterplan approval and strategic direction
Act 2025, sections 3–5, 11

Pakistan Digital Authority → Information Technology / Telecommunication Division: legal-policy alignment advice.
Oversight Committee reviews Pakistan Digital Authority; reports to National Digital Commission (sections 9–10).
These programme roles do not replace Law or House decisions.

A proposed Legislative Intelligence service must identify each decision's legal basis; no project-specific approval is presumed.

Figure 3. Bounded interfaces: advice, parliamentary support and digital-programme decisions do not create new legislative gates.
Sources: the constitutional, law-reform, parliamentary-services and digital-programme authorities in notes 7 and 17–20.

LEGAL RECORDS AND MACHINE-READABLE LEGISLATION

The Ministry of Law and Justice's legal-information work forms part of this foundation. Its **Archiving and Digitalization of Legislation and Record** project identifies a Document Retrieval System and a Library Management Information System; a February 2026 ministerial account reports

digitisation of 176 years of legislative history through that system, against a June 2025 prospective completion date in the earlier project document. These records establish a described programme and its reported reach, not the completeness of the collection.[21] Pakistan Code and the Ministry's Urdu-translation work likewise precede the present proposal.[22]

A Pakistan Digital Authority account of a joint consultation with the Ministry on 14 September 2026 records work on machine-readable legislation, Akoma Ntoso and Policy-as-Code, including an application demonstration with financial and other regulators.[23] The programme proposed here should engage with that work; a consultation and a demonstration are not a validated national service.

DNP-X.001 FWK (version 1.0, 13 May 2026) excludes primary legislation from its stated scope, and its section 5.2 offers examples rather than evidence that each named legal standard has been issued. Its distinction between full-text structured documents and metadata identifies what a representation contains, not its legal significance.[24]

DNP-L.400 PRF, the Pakistan AKN Application Profile, is Committee Draft/PILOT version 0.1, revised on 30 June 2026: a proposed Pakistan-specific representation and exchange profile, not an adopted, generally binding legislative publication regime. Its normative references name the 2018 Akoma Ntoso version 1.0. OASIS has since issued **Akoma Ntoso version 2.0, Part 2, Specifications of AKN 3.1**, as an OASIS Standard dated 2 October 2026; the new edition does not silently change the Pakistan draft's dependencies.[25]

The legislative source service proposed in this paper should therefore preserve original official files and their publication evidence, use a declared document profile and pinned schema, and maintain a separately tested compatibility export for the Pakistan draft where needed. A checksum establishes byte identity, not official authenticity. Structured versions should distinguish enactment, commencement, amendment, translation and editorial consolidation, and existing citation links should continue to resolve when new identifiers are introduced.

The architecture and service publications occupy different stages. **DNP-D.002 RA**, the WASL reference architecture, is Published/PILOT version 1.0 of 13 May 2026; its citizen-delegated artificial intelligence agent architecture is reserved for version 2. The **DNP-G.100** service-design and **DNP-G.110** accessibility documents of 8 October 2026 are Public Comment Drafts at PILOT maturity, with approval pending; G.100 encourages provincial adoption, while G.110 excludes provincial services from its operative scope.[26] Each standard therefore needs its own version, approval, scope and legal route established; a portal listing or a mandatory-sounding draft clause is not a working implementation.

[21] Ministry of Law and Justice, *Archiving and Digitalization of Legislation and Record* (project note, one page); Press Information Department, PR 264 (26 February 2026) paras 1–3.

[22] Press Information Department, PR 53 (7 February 2024), account of Pakistan Code, Urdu translations and legal-information systems.

[23] Pakistan Digital Authority, account of consultation with the Ministry of Law and Justice on machine-readable legislation (14 September 2026).

[24] Pakistan Digital Authority, DNP-X.001 FWK (version 1.0, 13 May 2026) ss 1 and 5.2, annex A.7.

[25] Pakistan Digital Authority, DNP-L.400 PRF, 'Pakistan AKN Application Profile' (Committee Draft/PILOT v0.1, June 2026; revision history 30 June 2026), document control and cls 1–2; OASIS, 'Akoma Ntoso Version 2.0, Part 2: Specifications of AKN 3.1' (OASIS Standard, 2 October 2026), official namespace record and normative-reference entry. The local draft names the 2018 version 1.0 dependencies; no silent substitution is assumed.

[26] Pakistan Digital Authority, DNP-D.002 RA, 'WASL Reference Architecture' (Published/PILOT v1.0, 13 May 2026), document control and annex I; DNP-G.100 STD, 'Service Design and Citizen Experience Standard', and DNP-G.110 STD, 'Website Accessibility Standard' (both Public Comment Draft/PILOT v1.0, 8 October 2026), document control and scope. Official indexed publication text consulted on 30 October 2026.

The wider standards comparison supports a layered rather than universal format. European Legislation Identifier (ELI)-informed identifiers and metadata can support citation, the PROV Ontology (PROV-O) provenance, the Simple Knowledge Organization System (SKOS) subject organisation and the Data Catalog Vocabulary (DCAT) collection description; none determines legal force. The LEX Uniform Resource Name (URN) specification is an informational Request for Comments (RFC), not an Internet Engineering Task Force (IETF) standard. Accessible Hypertext Markup Language (HTML) should be tested against the Web Content Accessibility Guidelines (WCAG) 2.2 at Level AA. LegalRuleML belongs to a separately reviewed rules layer, after interpretation, exceptions and temporal cases have been settled for the proposed use.[27]

Jurisdictional formats should be connected through explicit adapters. The UK legislation service distinguishes identifiers from version-specific links; the United States Government Publishing Office (GPO) distinguishes adopted United States Legislative Markup (USLM) 2.1.0 from proposed revisions; and the European Union (EU) Akoma Ntoso profile for European Union legal documents (AKN4EU) is still described as work in progress although AKN 3.1 has advanced. Each source's declared version should be preserved rather than forced into a supposedly universal latest schema. The European Case Law Identifier (ECLI) concerns case law, not legislation, and PDF Universal Accessibility (PDF/UA-2) is an accessibility specification distinct from legal authority and archival status.

Four kinds of work should consequently be kept distinct. Digitisation makes a record preservable and retrievable. Machine-readable structure identifies provisions, references, versions and metadata. Legislative intelligence relates those records to institutional questions and reviewable reasons. Executable rules additionally express conditions and outcomes for operation. The last introduces questions about interpretation, exceptions, temporal application and authority which a successful scan or a well-formed document cannot answer.

Three connected records for practical use

These distinctions should govern the proposed service at the level of an individual provision. The first record is the legislation itself: the instrument, its parts, sections, subsections and schedules, with the source version and subsequent legal events. A section remains identifiable when its wording changes. A page number or a position in extracted text can locate evidence, but cannot replace the provision's legal identity. An editorially reconstructed heading should be distinguishable from wording found in the instrument.

The second record concerns authority and responsibility. A rule should point to its enabling provision, the lawful maker, the subject and territorial scope, required consultation or approval, publication and commencement. An institutional connection should identify its basis in the Constitution, an enactment or the relevant allocation of business. Responsibility may change without the underlying Act being repealed. The

[27] Publications Office of the European Union, 'ELI implementation guide' (ontology 1.4); W3C, 'PROV-O' (Recommendation, 30 April 2013), 'SKOS Reference' (Recommendation, 18 August 2009), 'DCAT 3' (Recommendation, 22 August 2024), and 'WCAG 2.2' (Recommendation, republication 12 December 2024); RFC Editor, RFC 9676 (May 2025), status notice; OASIS, 'LegalRuleML Core Specification v1.0' (OASIS Standard, 30 August 2021). Their proposed combination is this paper's recommendation, not a certification. Comparative implementation records: legislation.gov.uk XML developer documentation; US Government Publishing Office USLM repository; Publications Office AKN4EU asset and scope records; European e-Justice ECLI description; ISO 14289-2:2024 catalogue (abstract inspected, not the paid full standard).

map must therefore retain the dates and instruments supporting both the legal rule and the institutional allocation.

The third record is a reviewed decision model for a defined use. It should identify the applicable provision and version, facts required, conditions, exceptions, consequences and matters reserved for judgment. Missing evidence, conflicting sources and a legally discretionary decision require different responses; none should be converted silently into an automatic refusal or permission. A model may expose a drafting defect or support an authorised process. It cannot confer jurisdiction, determine a contested interpretation by its own operation or replace the legally responsible decision-maker.

The initial institutional enquiry should establish who maintains each source, how amendments and corrections are incorporated, which periods and languages are covered, and how parliamentary services can use the records. Cooperation on these matters would be more useful than duplicating collections or treating existing work as though it began with this paper.

A participating House would commission its own work through its authorised arrangements. The Pakistan Institute for Parliamentary Services and the relevant research and drafting services are possible collaborators, by agreement. Compatible standards could support federal and provincial work without transferring competence between them. Because Articles 142–144 allocate legislative competence between Parliament and the Provincial Assemblies and provide a separate consent-resolution route (see note 28), this paper proposes coordinated instruments that respect those allocations rather than an omnibus federal law which would obscure them.

04 / THE ENQUIRY

Provincial legislative judgment and the federal relationship

Provincial legislative intelligence must begin with the province's authority to decide. Article 142 reserves unlisted subjects to the Provincial Assemblies, subject to the shared competence over criminal law, criminal procedure and evidence. Under Article 143, where a provincial Act is repugnant to an Act which Parliament was competent to enact, the parliamentary Act prevails and the provincial Act is void to the extent of the repugnancy. Article 144 offers a consent-resolution route for parliamentary legislation on an unlisted matter; it imposes no federal clearance upon provincial legislation. Provincial executive arrangements rest upon Article 139 and each province's own rules of business.[28] Cooperation therefore requires an account of the subject and instrument before a common solution is proposed.

Evolutionary, Strategic and Anticipatory work then traces amendments and the authority to correct, identifies the lawful actors and choices, and tests dependence upon another government's resources, records or administration. Shared formats or analysis need not place provincial conclusions under federal supervision; neither the National Digital Commission nor the Pakistan Digital Authority substitutes for provincial competence or the Assembly's judgment.

Two constitutional distinctions govern every provincial route. Article 115 requires Provincial Government introduction or consent for Money Bills and for specified Bills or amendments involving expenditure from the Provincial Consolidated Fund

[28] Constitution of Pakistan 1973, arts 139 and 141–144. Article 144 additionally permits the relevant Provincial Assembly to amend or repeal the resulting Act as applicable to that province.

or withdrawal from the Public Account; the Speaker, not the government, decides Money Bill classification and supplies the certificate. Article 116 governs assent: ten days for assent or the return of a non-Money Bill, then, after reconsideration and repassage by a majority present and voting, ten days for assent followed by deemed assent. It does not expressly make silence on first presentation assent, and its periods differ from Article 105's reconsideration of executive advice.[29] An intelligence record should distinguish these acts rather than report one undifferentiated approval.

Punjab and the Capacity of the Assembly to Examine and Follow Through

For Punjab, the defensible starting point is the Assembly and constitutional route. Four identified executive amendments from August 2025 to August 2026, including amendments concerning the Law allocation, remain unavailable in operative form. This paper therefore presents no current Punjab Law departmental organogram and infers none from an earlier compilation; the constitutional responsibilities of the Provincial Government, Cabinet, Chief Minister and Advocate-General remain distinguishable from the unresolved administrative detail.[30]

The Assembly route makes preparation consequential. The Minister's notice must carry the Bill, a signed statement of objects and reasons and a certificate on its Money Bill character; the Finance Bill's exception from committee reference is not a declaration that every Money Bill shares it; and a drafting-committee route exists for formal or consequential amendments.[31]

Assistance should let members connect the Bill's reasons with the affected provisions, competence, fiscal assumptions and delegated matters, and test whether the institutions named in the clauses can perform their duties. A committee report could then separate a drafting defect from a policy dispute or an unsupported implementation assumption; the House retains the decision whether and how to amend.

Private members require usable assistance too, since rules 89–90 protect them against merely technical rejection. The Advocate-General may participate in the Assembly and qualifying committees without a vote by virtue of that office; this is not routine approval of every Bill.[32] Legal research should help formulate the questions requiring that professional judgment, without presenting an automated answer as the opinion given.

Follow-through has an existing procedural basis. Rule 154(5) provides committee examination of departmental expenditure, administration, delegated legislation and policy, with an action report within forty-five days, subject to its provisos; it is an oversight response period, not a general deadline for Bills.[33] A linked record could preserve

[29] Constitution of Pakistan 1973, arts 105, 115–116. Article 115(2)–(3) supplies the Money Bill definition and exclusions; clauses (4)–(5) assign classification and certification to the Speaker. Provincial budgets separately follow arts 120–126.

[30] Punjab Assembly Rules of Procedure 1997; Constitution of Pakistan 1973, arts 129–131, 139–140. Four outstanding operative notifications are SO(Cab-I)2-47/82.V-II(P), 20 August 2025; SO(CAB-I)2-47/85(VOL-II), 1 December 2025; SO(CAB-I)2-2/2001(P), 29 April 2026; and SO(CAB-I)2-4/2026(AMA), 1 August 2026. Their identification rests on official Lahore High Court bulletins; the operative amendments are not inferred from those summaries. September 2025 bulletin, 74. LHC consolidated 2026 bulletin through 15 October, respective issue pages 39 (item 26), 114 and 26, identifies the December 2025, April 2026 and August 2026 instruments.

[31] Punjab Assembly Rules 1997, rr 91 and 94–109, particularly rr 94–96 and the drafting-committee provision in r 109(2)–(3).

[32] Punjab Assembly Rules 1997, rr 89–90; Constitution of Pakistan 1973, arts 111 and 140. Article 111 refers to a committee of which the Advocate-General may be named a member; participation is not universal committee membership.

[33] Punjab Assembly Rules 1997, r 154(5). The provisos address, among other matters, a Speaker's reasoned restraint following a majority committee request and biannual examination of expenditure.

the recommendation, departmental answer, implementation evidence and unresolved question. Rules 111–113 permit reconsideration on a deemed-return basis following first-stage silence; publication is not proof that every provision has commenced.[34]

Sindh and the connection between legal feasibility and provincial coordination

Sindh places legal feasibility before the request for Cabinet consideration (Figure 4). The combined Law, Parliamentary Affairs and Criminal Prosecution allocation should not be redrawn as a separate federal-style Parliamentary Affairs ministry. These findings rest on the March 2024 compilation read with seven subsequently examined amendments through October 2026, not on a consolidation of every later Gazette notice.[35]

Legal feasibility depends on the material reaching Law: anticipated staffing, financing and enforcement conditions and earlier departmental experience should accompany the draft rather than follow its legal form. Rule 38's Law-vetting requirement and control of subsequent alterations are the point at which the department's reasons, Law's advice and later changes should be kept together.[35]

The Advocate-General relationship explains why the advice record cannot be reduced to a single clearance indicator. Under rule 29, consultation passes through Law and disagreement is conveyed verbatim; if the originating department rejects Law's view, the Law Minister and, if necessary, the Chief Minister decide. A record which suppressed the separate opinions would remove part of the question the responsible authority must resolve.[36]

The Inter-Provincial Coordination allocation substituted on 29 June 2026 includes analysis of provincial and federal proposals and evidence-based advisory and technical support to the Chief Secretary and Chief Minister. It is a possible partner for examining cross-government dependence, and confers no Assembly, assent or legislative approval power.[37]

In the House, rule 167 connects scrutiny to departmental expenditure, administration, delegated legislation and policy, with a two-week reply to oversight findings and recommendations.[38] The record should carry a question through the committee and consideration stages and examine the answer, rather than count receipt as correction. For assent, rule 116's Assembly Secretary transmission duty and executive rule 45's processing can be complementary layers; neither establishes an additional executive veto, and their administrative mechanics should be confirmed before any automated routing.[39]

Khyber Pakhtunkhwa and legal expertise within scrutiny

Khyber Pakhtunkhwa's 2025 Assembly rules, which replace the 1988 rules with savings, connect scrutiny

[34] Punjab Assembly Rules 1997, rr 111–113; Constitution of Pakistan 1973, art 116. Commencement must be established from the particular Act and any applicable commencement instrument; no general provincial commencement default is asserted here.

[35] Sindh Government Rules of Business 1986, rr 38, particularly sub-rule (v), and 45(i)–(vii); Schedule I item 22 and Schedule II item 22. The later amendments reviewed do not amend these core rules; this bounded reconciliation does not certify an exhaustive consolidation.

[36] Sindh Rules of Business 1986, r 29(iv)–(v).

[37] Sindh SGA&CD, notification of 29 June 2026, substituted Schedule II allocation for Inter-Provincial Coordination. The proposed intelligence partnership is this paper's recommendation, not a notified programme.

[38] Sindh Assembly, Rules of Procedure 2013, rr 99–114, and r 167, particularly sub-rule (7). No later amendment cut-off has been verified. The drafting committee's period is not to exceed seven days; the two-week oversight response is a different requirement.

[39] Sindh Assembly Rules 2013, rr 116–118; Sindh Rules of Business 1986, r 45(viii)–(ix). The endpoint and executive processing are potentially complementary; the sources do not establish an additional assent veto or an excluded intermediary. No Punjab-style first-presentation deemed-return provision is claimed for Sindh.

directly with legal expertise. Under rules 184–188 the departmental Secretary, the Law Secretary or nominee, and the Advocate-General or a nominee of at least Assistant Advocate-General rank provide expert opinion, subject to the prescribed attendance arrangements. These roles remain distinct from elected membership, and the Advocate-General's office carries no vote by virtue of that office.[40]

Because members, the department and legal officers bring different responsibilities to that encounter, a common dossier should set out the choices, authorities and administrative and fiscal dependencies, keep the history of contested clauses and retain questions left unanswered after the hearing, without making departmental expertise or generated analysis decisive.

On the executive side, rule 12 requires consultation with the Advocate-General through Law; where the department rejects Law's view after disagreement, the Law Minister decides and may refer the matter to Cabinet. Rule 11 provides financial consultation and a Cabinet decision where Finance has not concurred. The official compilation lacks a verified amendment cut-off, so these allocations remain edition-qualified,[41] and that limitation should travel with the affected record rather than be replaced by a more recent-looking title from another province.

Publication in the Gazette and on the official website, subject to stated exceptions, precedes committee reference and the three-clear-day interval; questions and alternatives must therefore arrive while members can still use them.[42] A shorter processing time is an inadequate success measure if it reduces the opportunity to examine material objections.

After passage, Assembly rules 132–133 and executive rule 29 describe complementary transmission, processing and publication duties; operational arrangements should identify who records each event without inventing another approval. Rule 134 permits deemed-return reconsideration after first-stage silence, not automatic assent.[43] Later enquiry should distinguish enactment, commencement, delegated instruments and actual administration; a provision's survival in the statute book does not show that its promised effect has followed.

Balochistan and continuity across departmental and Assembly responsibilities

In Balochistan, rule 38 of the Rules of Business, consolidated through 29 July 2026, has the originating department forward the completed legislative package to the Assembly after the prescribed Law and executive steps; that handoff should not be replaced with Sindh's or Khyber Pakhtunkhwa's route. Rule 17 preserves a distinct disagreement procedure: where the department rejects Law's view following disagreement with the Advocate-General, the Chief Minister decides.[44]

The Bill, reasons, consultation history, fiscal dependencies and outstanding choices should travel together across that handoff. Rule 15 needs care: referring a Finance refusal through the Chief

[40] Khyber Pakhtunkhwa Assembly, Procedure and Conduct of Business Rules 2025, rr 184–188 and 318. Read with Constitution of Pakistan 1973 art 111. The prescribed departmental substitute requires the chair's permission; the minimum Assistant Advocate-General rank concerns the Advocate-General's nominee.

[41] Khyber Pakhtunkhwa Government Rules of Business 1985, rr 4–5, 11, 12(3), (5)–(7), and Schedule II. The source does not establish a comprehensive current executive organogram.

[42] Khyber Pakhtunkhwa Assembly Rules 2025, rr 111 and 113–116. Rule 113 exceptions include the Article 128(3) Bill and same-day introduction, consideration and passage; the committee exception concerns the Finance Bill, not all Money Bills.

[43] Khyber Pakhtunkhwa Assembly Rules 2025, rr 132–134; Khyber Pakhtunkhwa Rules of Business 1985, r 29(5), (7). The Assembly transmission endpoint does not itself exclude executive processing, and no implied repeal or additional approval is asserted.

[44] Balochistan Government Rules of Business 2012, rr 17(3)–(9) and 38(1)–(3). Departmental forwarding follows the prescribed rr 17 and 24 steps; it does not dispense with legal or executive preparation.

Secretary to the Chief Minister does not erase the separate Cabinet-decision requirement for proceeding without concurrence.[45] A digital route should show which act has occurred, not treat a forwarded file as a resolved objection.

Balochistan's December 2025 Assembly rules show why maintenance is substantive work. Amended rule 81 permits Gazette publication of an introduced Bill where required, whereas executive rule 38 uses different publication wording; the two need administrative reconciliation for routing, not a declaration that they conflict. Under rules 84–85, the seven-day supply period and the three-clear-day consideration interval run from different events, and the Finance Bill follows rules 82–83.[46] A generic provincial timetable would misstate these triggers.

Rule 129(3) brings departmental and Law officers into committee assistance but, unlike Khyber Pakhtunkhwa's 2025 text, does not expressly require Advocate-General attendance.[47] Assistance should follow the committee's actual remit. Rules 99–100, including the December 2025 deemed-return addition, govern transmission, publication and return; the commencement and delegated powers of each Act still require examination.[48]

Cooperation without displacement of responsibility

The provincial differences determine what a connected programme must preserve. Shared research, interoperable records and comparative drafting could reduce duplicated work, but each contribution needs a provincial source, responsible recipient and lawful decision route. Advice, financial concurrence, committee recommendation, House passage and assent must remain separately identifiable. Executive provisions permitting dispensation with Cabinet reference, found in the retrieved Sindh, Khyber Pakhtunkhwa and Balochistan texts, are not relied upon here as authority for a digital shortcut or as a resolved account of their current constitutional application.[49]

The proposed federal–provincial relationship is consequently one of supported enquiry and accountable cooperation. Each participating institution would retain control of its questions and conclusions. Across preparation, scrutiny and follow-through, the work would examine authority and choice, foreseeable dependence and consequence, and evidence for correction together. The practical test is whether the responsible institution can obtain a reasoned account, challenge it and act through its own lawful means. A common platform would be useful to the extent that it serves that test.

[45] Balochistan Rules of Business 2012, r 15, particularly sub-rules (3)–(4).

[46] Balochistan Assembly, Rules of Procedure and Conduct of Business 1974, rr 81–85; Balochistan Rules of Business 2012, r 38(3). The seven-day supply period and three-clear-day consideration interval run from different events.

[47] Balochistan Assembly Rules 1974, rr 128–129, particularly rr 128(2) and 129(3). The departmental Secretary or designated officer of at least Additional Secretary rank and the Law Secretary or competent nominee attend as expert advisers; the absence of an express Advocate-General attendance requirement here is not a prohibition on participation otherwise lawfully available.

[48] Balochistan Assembly Rules 1974, rr 99–100, particularly r 100(2) proviso and (6); Balochistan Rules of Business 2012, r 38(7)–(11); Constitution of Pakistan 1973 art 116. The correct executive pinpoint for passed-Bill transmission is r 38(7).

[49] Sindh Rules of Business 1986, rr 11 and 13; Khyber Pakhtunkhwa Rules of Business 1985, r 19(2); Balochistan Rules of Business 2012, r 25. Constitutional application of the exceptions is reserved, not determined in favour of either a universal shortcut or their categorical invalidity.

FOUR PROVINCES, DISTINCT ROUTES

Executive preparation does not displace Assembly judgment

PUNJAB · Assembly and constitutional core

Minister's package → Assembly → committee / House stages.
Current executive allocation remains unresolved:
four identified 2025–26 amendments: operative text not retrieved.
Ordinary consideration interval: two clear days, with exception.

Assembly rules 91, 94–109; constitutional route retained

SINDH · legal feasibility before Cabinet request

Originating department → Law's legal shaping → Chief Minister approval to place the vetted proposal before Cabinet.
Combined Law / Parliamentary Affairs / Criminal Prosecution.
House: three clear days before ordinary consideration.

Executive rule 45; Assembly rules 99–114

KHYBER PAKHTUNKHWA · expertise in scrutiny

Department supplies policy → combined Law / Parliamentary Affairs / Human Rights provides legal shaping → House route.
2025 committees: departmental, Law and Advocate-General expertise under prescribed arrangements; no vote by office.

Executive rules 11–12, 29; Assembly rules 184–188

BALOCHISTAN · originating-department handoff

After prescribed Law / executive steps, the originating department sends the completed package to the Assembly.
Do not substitute another province's departmental route.

Executive rule 38; Assembly rules 81–85, 128–129

All four: passage ≠ assent ≠ publication ≠ commencement.

Figure 4. Four provincial routes: distinct preparation and scrutiny relationships, with Punjab's unresolved executive allocation kept visible. Sources: section 4, notes 28–49. Executive references identify each province's Rules of Business.

05 / THE ENQUIRY

What comparative experience establishes

Comparative experience shows how particular functions work, not which Pakistani institution should perform them. In the Inter-Parliamentary Union's *World e-Parliament Report 2024*, 29 per cent of 115 responding parliaments or chambers reported artificial intelligence use; its guidance ties human oversight to evaluation and to an authority able to withdraw a failing system.[50] Adoption is a condition, not an effect upon scrutiny.

Unless an evaluation is identified, the reported uses below show neither improved legislative quality nor a transferable saving.

Drafting and parliamentary workflow

01 / United Kingdom and Scotland / Routine use

The National Archives' 2023–24 annual report records routine use of **Lawmaker** by more than 1,000 users across UK and Scottish parliamentary and government drafting bodies, for all Bills before both Parliaments.[51] The question for Pakistan is whether a shared drafting record would carry the work of scrutiny from one stage to the next.

02 / European Union / Production and research

The European Commission reports **EdiT**, based on the LEOS editor, in production for five Ordinary Legislative Procedure proposal templates, with delegated and implementing acts planned for 2027–28; the *Augmented LEOS* report is a separate study of prospective functions.[52] Structured editing prevents some document defects; whether provisions are lawful and justified remains for the responsible reviewers.

03 / India / Reported deployment

India's **National e-Vidhan Application** distinguishes 28 legislatures with memoranda from 21 conducting digital business and seven in implementation.[53] A federal programme should record each legislature's responsibilities and stage, not one aggregate claim of completion.

Records and fiscal analysis

04 / Finland / Research prototype

ParliamentSampo, a university linked-data prototype, connects speeches and speakers and records its own corrections and additions;[54] Gagnon and Azzi offer a research design for semantic annotation and citizen enquiry, not an evaluated parliamentary service.[55] Enrichment must remain distinguishable from the official record, and omitted material recoverable.

[50] Inter-Parliamentary Union, *World e-Parliament Report 2024* (2024) 5, 19, 61–62; Inter-Parliamentary Union, *Guidelines for AI in Parliaments* (2024) 18–19, 82–85, 110.

[51] The National Archives, *Annual Report and Accounts 2023–24* (HC 71, 25 July 2024) 23–24.

[52] European Commission, 'Legal interoperability highlights' (22 September 2026, updated 8 October 2026), 'Institutional rollout', Q3 and Q5; Fotios Fitsilis, George Mikros and Sotiris Leventis, *Augmented LEOS: Final Report* (February 2024) 5 and chs 3–4, 20–36.

[53] Ministry of Parliamentary Affairs, '21 State/UT Legislatures Conduct Business in Digital Mode through NeVA, 7 More at various Stages of Implementation' (Press Information Bureau, 11 March 2026) paras 1–4.

[54] SeCo, 'Parlamenttisampo', 'Tulokset' and 'Parlamenttisammon aineistot ja portaali verkossa' (accessed 30 October 2026); *Parlamenttisammon käyttöohje* (11 June 2025) 1.

[55] Stéphane Gagnon and Sabrina Azzi, 'Semantic Annotation of Parliamentary Debates and Legislative Intelligence Enhancing Citizen Experience' in Andrea Kő and others (eds), *Electronic Government and the Information Systems Perspective* (LNCS 13429, Springer 2022) 63 (accepted manuscript), doi:10.1007/978-3-031-12673-4_5.

05 / Kenya / Official records

Kenya Law's consolidation account stresses editorial tools, task tracking, approvals and publication support alongside structured Extensible Markup Language (XML).[56] A format does not by itself maintain versions, corrections or publication.

Canada's online Financial Administration Act links the parent Act to its regulations, including repealed ones, and back again; Australia's register separates title from compilation identifiers and registration from effective dates.[57] The lesson is an evidenced relationship between records, not a foreign rule of domestic authority.

06 / France / Observed analytical use

A filed, later withdrawn amendment to France's 2026 social-security financing Bill relied on the National Assembly's **LexImpact** estimates.[58] That shows use in preparing a proposal, not enactment or accuracy; the capability worth seeking is independent fiscal analysis with its assumptions, year and confidentiality requirements intact.

Participation and institutional response

07 / Brazil / Institutional account

Brazil's Chamber describes **Ulysses** classification and routing; an Inter-Parliamentary Union and United Nations Development Programme case study of **e-Democracia**'s Wikilegis records the absence of clear success measures.[59] Because classification decides which distinctions survive, the original contribution and a route to question its treatment should remain available.

Research on one e-Democracia community found unequal participation and internal mediation of proposals, on a small sample; an earlier comparison traced differences to institutional willingness, resources and incentives rather than platform availability.[60] Participation needs an account of who receives a contribution, what consideration follows and why it is accepted or rejected.

08 / Chile / Procedural design

Chile's **Congreso Virtual** routes consultation, with institutionally prepared summaries and questions, to the committee before its general vote.[61] Whether it informs the choice requires evidence of receipt, response and resulting change.

[56] Kenya Law, 'About Kenya Law', 'Organizational Profile' and 'Mandate and functions', and 'Laws of Kenya' (accessed 30 October 2026); Greg Kempe, 'Using Laws.Africa's technology to bolster Kenya's legal framework' (Open Law Africa, accessed 30 October 2026), 'Challenges faced' and 'Technological innovation'.

[57] Department of Justice Canada, Financial Administration Act, contents and regulations listings, and Accountable Advances Regulations, enabling-Act link; Australian Government, Legislation Act 2003, Details and All versions (accessed 31 October 2026). Canadian Act; Regulations; Australian details; Versions.

[58] Assemblée nationale, 'LexImpact: À propos', 'Qui sommes-nous?' and 'Les services proposés' (accessed 30 October 2026); Assemblée nationale, amendement no 2424 au projet de loi de financement de la sécurité sociale pour 2026, texte no 1907 (1 November 2025) 1, 3–4.

[59] Câmara dos Deputados, 'Prática do ano: Ulysses' (institutional account, accessed 30 October 2026); Agência Câmara, 'Câmara lança nova fase do programa Ulysses e políticas de governança em Inteligência Artificial' (11 December 2025) paras 3–6 and 'Base sólida'; IPU and UNDP, *Global Parliamentary Report 2022: Annex—Case Studies and Practical Guides* (2022), 'Brazil: Digital engagement', 5–8.

[60] Christiana Soares de Freitas, Fernanda Fiuza Lima and Fernanda Queiroz Lima, 'Os Desafios ao Desenvolvimento de um Ambiente para Participação Política Digital: o Caso de uma Comunidade Virtual Legislativa do Projeto e-Democracia no Brasil' (2015) 22(75) *Organizações & Sociedade* 639, 'Metodologia', 'Os participantes' and 'Razões para participação'; Francisco Paulo Jamil Almeida Marques, 'Government and e-participation programs: A study of the challenges faced by institutional projects' (2010) 15(8) *First Monday*, repository PDF 2–3, 7–8.

[61] Biblioteca del Congreso Nacional de Chile, 'Senado y Cámara lanzan plataforma "Congreso Virtual" para enriquecer el proceso legislativo con la participación ciudadana', 'Funcionamiento del Congreso Virtual', paras 1–6 (accessed 30 October 2026).

Representation, interpretation and legal authority

New Zealand's 2018 **Better Rules** discovery used legal, policy and software modelling to expose definitional and service-delivery questions;[62] Germany's **SPRIND Law as Code** programme states ambitions for formal representation and implementation.[63] Neither is an authoritative executable statute book; their value lies in what modelling reveals before use.

Germany's ministry reserves discretionary and evaluative cases for human assessment, and its innovation agency treats review, authorisation, version maintenance and operation as part of representation.[64] Pakistan should identify who may approve, correct and withdraw a representation before choosing an execution system.

The 2026 consultation of the Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development (OECD) on a shared reference framework for the digital provision of enacted law expects final publication in late 2027 or early 2028. It is neither a completed standard nor a binding deadline, and its scope is narrower than the drafting, scrutiny and participation examined here.[65]

Mohun and Roberts's OECD working paper separates machine-consumable rules from natural-language law and examines legal status and versioning; Akoma Ntoso separates authorial content from editorial markup.[66] A correct structure cannot settle a contested interpretation, and successful execution cannot supply authority for the rule executed.

Hildebrandt and Diver examine the design choices and assumptions fixed before code executes;[67] Fraser and Barraclough extend governance to interpretations embedded in data and specifications, without code replacing enacted law.[68] Evaluation must reach excluded cases, legal effects and contestability, not technical success alone.

Commercial products advertising legislative tracking, source-grounded research and workflow management[69] still require evidence of accuracy, review effort, cost and fitness for the institution concerned.

Rulemapping describes visual, traceable decision models and an open Law as Code initiative; these are the developer's descriptions.[70] A deterministic model

[62] New Zealand Digital Government, *Better Rules for Government Discovery Report* (2018), 'Approach', 'Service delivery problems' and 'Approach to experiments'.

[63] SPRIND, 'Law as Code' (strategic-project description, accessed 30 October 2026).

[64] German Federal Ministry for Digital Transformation and Government Modernisation, 'Law as Code', 'Law as Code und Rulemapping: Nächste Schritte'; Federal Agency for Breakthrough Innovation, 'Law as Code', 'What does Law as Code require?' (accessed 31 October 2026). Programme descriptions, not evidence of a completed authoritative executable statute book. Ministry account; Programme.

[65] Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development, 'Consultation on the digital provision of law: Towards a shared reference framework for law as code', Purpose, Scope and Timeline (accessed 31 October 2026). The consultation concerns digital provision of enacted law; its expected publication date is not a binding standard or legal commencement date. Consultation.

[66] James Mohun and Alex Roberts, *Cracking the Code: Rulemaking for Humans and Machines* (OECD Working Papers on Public Governance No 42, 2020) 6–7, 78–81; OASIS, 'Akoma Ntoso Version 1.0, Part 1: XML Vocabulary' (29 August 2018) ss 4.3–4.4.

[67] Mireille Hildebrandt, 'The Future of Computational Law in the Context of the Rule of Law' (2024) 2(2) *Journal of Cross-disciplinary Research in Computational Law*, 5–7 (PDF pagination); Laurence Diver, 'Interpreting the Rule(s) of Code: Performance, Performativity, and Production' (*MIT Computational Law Report*, 7 December 2021, release 4) ss 2.2, 3.3–3.4.

[68] Hamish Fraser and Tom Barraclough, 'Governing Digital Legal Systems: Insights on Artificial Intelligence and Rules as Code' (*MIT Computational Law Report*, 14 October 2024, release 2), governance discussion, drinking-water reporting example and parallel-drafting discussion.

[69] InstaTrac, 'Legislative Intelligence' (20 June 2025); Apogee, 'Legislative Intelligence'; Cloudwick, 'Legislative Intelligence' (product descriptions accessed 30 October 2026).

[70] Rulemapping Group, 'Rule AI', 'Reasoning built on legal logic' and 'From legislation to execution'; 'Law as Code', Guiding principles and Rulemap Builder (accessed 31 October 2026). These are supplier and initiative descriptions; software performance, licensing and interoperability have not been established by them. Product description; Principles.

reproduces an error in its premise consistently, so acceptance must test source, interpretation, version and excluded cases, and openness the actual licence, specification and export.

Table 2. Comparative functions and limits

Each row identifies the notes containing its sources. Each lesson concerns the function shown, not transferable institutional performance.

Comparator	Record and function shown	Lesson and limit
Lawmaker (note 51)	Official annual report of routine shared drafting	Connect drafting stages; use alone does not establish better scrutiny.
EdiT / LEOS (note 52)	Production editing account; separate feasibility research	Preserve structure; prospective functions are not deployed results.
India NeVA (note 53)	Parliamentary-answer account distinguishing agreement and operation	Record each legislature's stage; an agreement is not operational capacity.
ParliamentSampo (note 54)	University research prototype and manual	Keep enrichment distinguishable from the official record; not an evaluated parliamentary service.
Kenya Law (note 56)	Official collection and delivery-partner consolidation account	Maintain editorial and publication responsibility; a format alone supplies neither.
LexImpact (note 58)	Filed amendment using fiscal estimates, later withdrawn	Make assumptions examinable; use proves neither accuracy nor enactment.
Brazil Ulysses / e-Democracia (notes 59–60)	Institutional accounts and qualified participation research	Preserve contributions and review their treatment; participation and success measures remain uneven.
Chile Congreso Virtual (note 61)	Institutional account of consultation before committee consideration	Connect consultation to an open choice; receipt, response and effect still require evidence.
Better Rules / SPRIND (notes 62–63)	Discovery work and programme ambitions	Modelling can reveal design questions; no authoritative executable statute book is established here.
OECD / Akoma Ntoso and scholarship (notes 66–68)	Analytical distinctions, structural standards and interpretive criticism	Separate representation, interpretation and authority; technical validity cannot settle the legal conclusion.

06 / THE ENQUIRY

From a legal record to legislative judgment

The first responsibility of a legislative dossier is to establish what is being examined. A document needs an issuer or author, jurisdiction, category, date, version and passage locator. Publication, assent, commencement and amendment answer different questions. Where text has been extracted or translated, the reader should be able to return to the source image and examine a disputed name, number or provision.

The reading arrangement should make that discipline usable. The United Kingdom's provision-level reader distinguishes contents, an individual section and its amendment history. New Zealand's published guidance describes retaining a selected section when changing versions and locating secondary legislation through its empowering provision. These are useful design lessons for a service in which readers move between the governing provision, the surrounding text and the instrument which changed it. The comparison concerns observable or documented functions, not proof that a particular interface improves legal understanding.[71]

For the legislative source service proposed in this paper, this suggests a legislation reader with a visible title list, title and full-text search, jurisdiction, year and instrument filters, and a contents panel following the instrument's actual hierarchy. Search results should open the cited provision in context. A reusable text or structured download should preserve its source, version and provision identifiers, and an accessible source image remains necessary where extraction is incomplete. Checksums and extraction offsets belong in an expandable provenance record, not in place of the law which the reader came to consult.

Relationships between documents require the same care. A report may propose an amendment; a Bill may concern the same statute; an Act may later carry a similar title. Whether the Act adopts the recommendation depends upon its provisions and legislative record. The connection cannot be supplied by resemblance alone. Likewise, a speech records an argument made by a particular speaker; the legal use of that argument requires a further judgment about the applicable interpretive rules.

A legislative journey should similarly preserve successive texts and procedural acts. Louisiana's 2026 appropriations Bill record links original, engrossed, enrolled and enacted texts to amendments, votes and dated actions. Its history qualifies the headline signing status with line-item vetoes and a separate effective date. The lesson is the preservation of a legally consequential qualification, not the transplantation of American executive powers. A Pakistani dossier should link its own Bill versions, committee reports, amendments, messages, assent and commencement evidence according to the applicable constitutional route.[72]

[71] The National Archives, Human Rights Act 1998, contents and section 6 reader; New Zealand Legislation, 'Navigate legislation', version selection, section view and secondary-legislation guidance (examined 31 October 2026). United Kingdom reader inspection and New Zealand published guidance concern interface functions; no comparative user-outcome evaluation is asserted. Contents; Section reader; New Zealand guidance.

[72] Louisiana State Legislature, House Bill 1, 2026 Regular Session, Text, Amendments, Votes and dated history, including 18 June 2026 (accessed 31 October 2026). The comparison concerns record design; it does not transfer Louisiana's constitutional powers or procedures to Pakistan. Bill record.

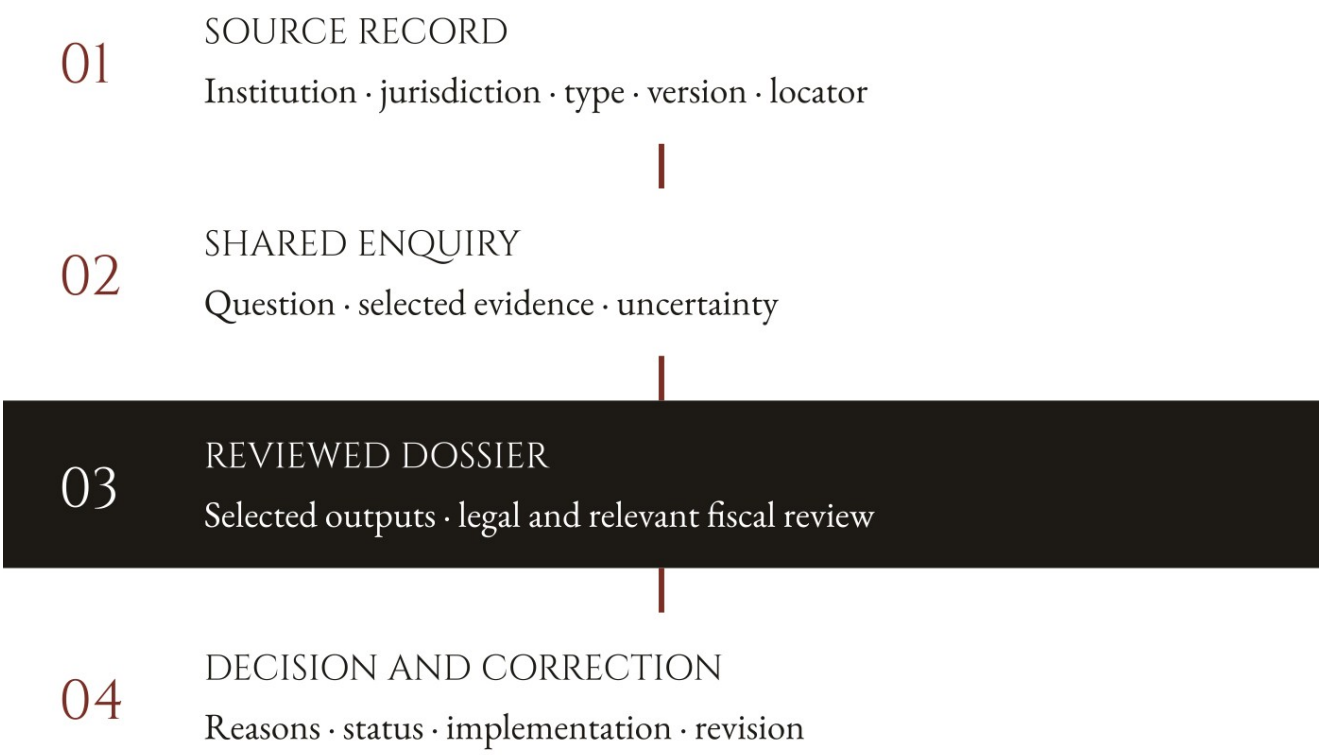


Figure 5. From the source record through shared enquiry and reviewed dossier to decision and correction. Summary of section 6.

The dossier should preserve these distinctions while producing forms of analysis suited to different decisions. **Legislative History** establishes the development of the text and the version relevant to the enquiry. **Legislative Debates** identifies the arguments, speakers, stages and recorded action, with sufficient context to examine a quotation. Together they make the record intelligible without filling gaps with an assumed intention.

Legislative Assessment considers competence, rights, affected interests, alternatives, institutional and fiscal effects, implementation and review. **Legislative Memo** draws from that assessment to answer the question before a member, committee or other reader. A short memo can be useful because the underlying enquiry is exact; brevity cannot compensate for an unresolved legal premise.

Legislative Framework establishes how a proposed arrangement would fit the law already in place. It identifies powers and duties, consequential amendments and the treatment of existing proceedings, records, appointments and other interests during transition. This work needs particular attention because a new allocation can leave an old dependency untouched or create a conflict which a general override clause conceals.

Policy Brief brings the choices and their consequences before the responsible institution. **Draft Legislative Proposals** then give the selected approach legal form, with the target version and reasons for material changes. Drafting at an earlier stage can quietly decide the question which the analysis was meant to expose.

These seven outputs need not become seven separate documents. Their extent should follow the question. What matters is that a reader can move from the conclusion to its legal and factual premises, identify who reviewed them and understand why another course was rejected. A later correction should reach the conclusions which depended upon

the changed premise. The banking-dispute enquiry illustrates the consequences of that discipline.

Table 3. Questions across the forms of analysis

All three intelligences operate together in each form. The questions indicate their contribution without ranking them or assigning any dimension to a single stage. Their depth follows the decision and the material risk; the table creates no requirement to produce seven documents.

Form	Evolutionary	Strategic	Anticipatory
Legislative History	What changed, and why?	Which allocation did the provision establish?	Which assumptions and consequences shaped it?
Legislative Debates	How did wording and positions develop?	Whose choices and reasons are recorded?	Which consequences and objections were examined?
Legislative Assessment	What evidence would justify correction?	Who may act, by what means?	What dependencies or failures affect the choice?
Legislative Memo	What would change the advice?	What decision is now available?	What material consequence needs attention?
Legislative Framework	How will transition and revision work?	How do powers and duties fit together?	Where could the arrangement fail or exclude?
Policy Brief	How will their results be reviewed?	Which course can the institution justify?	What costs and consequences distinguish the courses?
Draft Legislative Proposals	Are amendment, transition and review workable?	Does the wording express the lawful choice?	Are safeguards and practical dependencies addressed?

An intelligence framework across the legislative cycle

The forms of work above should connect successive decisions rather than become a parallel bureaucracy. The following framework proposes how an authorised enquiry would move through the legal routes examined in sections 3 and 4. It gives no researcher, analyst or digital platform an approval power. The institution responsible for each decision retains that decision; independent parliamentary analysis need not adopt the executive's preferred answer. Evolutionary, Strategic and Anticipatory Legal Intelligence operate together at every stage.

Table 4. Legislative stages, intelligence work and accountable outputs

Stage and responsible decision	Proposed intelligence work	Output and review gate
Problem and options. The responsible Division and Minister identify a policy problem; members and committees may frame their own scrutiny questions.	Evolutionary: reconstruct earlier interventions and failures. Strategic: compare use of existing powers, administrative action and legislation. Anticipatory: identify affected interests, likely burdens and delivery constraints.	A problem-and-options brief with the strongest alternative and an evidence baseline. The sponsor defines a bounded question; the reviewer verifies sources and lawful access before recommending a legislative response.
Competence and policy instruction. The responsible executive actor chooses the policy; Law advises on competence and legal means.	Evolutionary: trace the existing provisions, amendments and transition. Strategic: identify the competent legislature, sponsoring authority and correct constitutional route. Anticipatory: examine fiscal, intergovernmental and delegated-power dependencies.	A competence-and-route note and policy instruction identifying what is decided and what remains open. National importance does not supply federal competence; expenditure alone does not determine Money Bill status.
Consultation and executive decision. Concerned departments, Law, Finance and the prescribed executive decision-makers perform their distinct functions; the proposed enquiry also seeks affected public and stakeholder evidence.	Evolutionary: retain earlier opinions and reasons for revisions. Strategic: separate advice, concurrence, disagreement and approval. Anticipatory: test resources, administrative capacity and dependencies before settling the draft.	A consultation-and-decision schedule with the exact approval sought, separate legal and fiscal opinions, responses to public comments and unresolved questions. The relevant actor records its own decision; an analyst cannot supply missing concurrence or turn disagreement into clearance.
Drafting and introduction. Law performs its prescribed drafting and scrutiny; the sponsor settles policy decisions; Parliamentary Affairs coordinates government business within House procedure; the Minister-in-charge introduces the Government Bill through the prescribed route.	Evolutionary: preserve clause changes and reasons. Strategic: test whether wording implements the authorised choice. Anticipatory: examine exceptions, remedies, commencement and operational scenarios.	A reviewed Bill, clause comparison and linked reasons, with outstanding choices visible. The legal handoff is recorded; scheduling remains a competent institutional decision, not a platform entitlement.

Stage and responsible decision	Proposed intelligence work	Output and review gate
Scrutiny, amendment and passage. Committees examine evidence and recommend; each House exercises its own constitutional and procedural powers.	Evolutionary: connect amendments with the original reasons and earlier settlements. Strategic: distinguish legal defects, contested policy and unsupported assumptions. Anticipatory: compare consequences of competing wording and delivery arrangements.	An independent committee dossier and amendment comparison preserve debate speakers and dates, evidence and each House's versions, returns and decisions. Procedural and legal reviewers check the route; special constitutional tracks remain those in section 3. No executive workflow overrides House decisions.
Assent, publication and operation. The constitutional assent actor and prescribed secretariat and executive offices perform distinct acts.	Evolutionary: preserve the text through passage, return, reconsideration and enactment. Strategic: establish which legal event has occurred. Anticipatory: identify uncommenced provisions, missing subordinate instruments and transition risks.	An enactment-and-operation register linking authoritative text, assent and publication evidence, commencement provisions and instruments made under delegated powers. A publication record is not treated as universal commencement.
Implementation and correction. Implementing authorities act; parliamentary bodies scrutinise; competent institutions decide amendment, repeal or administrative remedy.	Evolutionary: compare results with the original reasons and maintain the correction history. Strategic: distinguish defects in law, administration, resources and responsibility. Anticipatory: test recurring costs, access barriers and continuity after project finance.	A recommendation–response–evidence record follows governmental assurances and undertakings. Litigation findings inform the responsible department, Law and the Commission's reform work within their remits. A reasoned decision may maintain, narrow, amend or discontinue; receipt is not correction, and changing a model cannot change the law.

Each handoff should carry the question, applicable text, reasons, unresolved matters and the identity of the actor entitled to decide. A change of responsible office should not erase contrary evidence or earlier objections. Research conclusions and institutional decisions should be recorded separately so that a reader can distinguish advice from adoption and a proposed timetable from events which actually occurred.

For each stage, the working record should identify the competent actor, legal basis, question submitted, text version, decision or advice given, date, reasons and the next lawful recipient. A recommendation, concurrence, approval and transmission should be recorded as different acts. The relevant House's committee and amendment records should remain under its control. After enactment, the same chain should connect commencement, delegated instruments, implementation responsibilities and the evidence required for scrutiny. A reader should be able to move backwards from an institutional action to its authority and forwards from a provision to the duties and review arrangements which depend upon it.

Institutional relevance is not proof of continuing legal force. South Africa's justice overview groups legislation by public function, but lists an older courts Act before explaining its repeal later in the account. A useful responsibility map should place a replacement or historical relationship beside the affected record. The instrument may remain

important to the institution's history without remaining the source of a present power. This is particularly important when administrative reorganisations, repeal and replacement operate on different dates.[73]

The framework requires local adaptation, not federal replication. Provincial combined departments, consultation and escalation routes, committee exceptions and transmission arrangements remain those examined in section 4. Ordinary federal legislation, Money Bills and constitutional amendments retain their distinct routes. A particular Act's commencement and delegated powers must be read before operational steps are modelled. The proposed service can expose an uncertain allocation or missing source; it cannot settle either by assigning a digital task.

Federal and provincial records should share a vocabulary of sources, provisions, events and decisions, while retaining their distinct actors and routes. A common field for legal advice would not make every Law Department's function identical. A provincial Assembly's referral exception, the originating department's transmission duty and the Governor's constitutional function must remain tied to that province's sources. Where a proposal crosses jurisdictions, the dossier should identify the legal basis for cooperation and each institution's own decision, rather than treat a common digital workspace as a common legislative competence.

The two worked enquiries below test this framework rather than merely illustrate its vocabulary. The banking enquiry distinguishes the enacted housing-finance process from the Commission's proposed court-connected procedure, then asks how further reform would interact with the law and the available institutions. The digital enquiry begins with existing statutory and contractual responsibilities and asks what evidence would establish delivery, correction and durable institutional ownership. In each, legislative intelligence should support a better-grounded decision, including a reasoned decision not to proceed.

07 / THE ENQUIRY

The banking dispute enquiry

The recommendation and the legal record

The question is whether Pakistan should support the banking-dispute alternative dispute resolution model proposed in Law Reform Report 139 of the Law and Justice Commission of Pakistan, seek revisions, or first establish the evidence and capacity for a narrower approach. The full report proposes section 10A of the Financial Institutions (Recovery of Finances) Ordinance 2001. The Commission approved the recommendation on 11 June 2026 for consideration and legislative action by the Federal Government.[74]

The final Gazette establishes the distinct housing-finance route. Act XLVI of 2026, assented to on 11 August and published on 17 August, amends definitions, inserts section 15A and amends section 22(6). It commences at once and does not insert proposed section 10A.[75]

[73] South African Government, 'Legislation and policies', Introduction, Supreme Court Act 1959 listing and subsequent explanation of replacement by the Superior Courts Act 2013 (accessed 31 October 2026). The observation concerns the presentation of historical and current institutional relationships. Institutional overview.

[74] Law and Justice Commission of Pakistan, *Amendment in the Financial Institutions (Recovery of Finances) Ordinance, 2001: Introducing Alternative Dispute Resolution Framework for Banking Disputes* (*Law Reform Report No 139*, 2026) 5; LJCP, 'LJCP Approves Alternative Dispute Resolution Framework for Banking Disputes and Reviews Progress on Key Law Reform Initiatives' (11 June 2026).

[75] Financial Institutions (Recovery of Finances) (Amendment) Act 2026, Act XLVI of 2026, sections 1–4, Gazette of Pakistan, Extraordinary, Part I, 17 August 2026, 853–859. Assent: 11 August 2026. Official

Gazette.

Figure 6. Two legislative histories: housing finance and dispute resolution reform.

Housing finance

Enacted section 15A

March 2026

Same-titled amendment referred to the National Assembly's Finance and Revenue Committee.

11 and 17 August 2026

Presidential assent on 11 August; Gazette publication on 17 August.

Act XLVI of 2026

Definitions amended, section 15A inserted and section 22(6) amended. The enacted text includes a distinct pre-sale settlement procedure.

Dispute resolution reform

Proposed section 10A

11 June 2026

The Commission approved the recommendation in Law Reform Report 139 for consideration and legislative action.

Separate mechanism

The recommendation concerns a court-connected framework for banking disputes.

Record examined

Neither Act XLVI of 2026 nor the posted consolidation incorporating it contains proposed section 10A. Later amendments require separate examination.

Different provisions require distinct legislative histories.

The enacted housing-finance amendment and the separate reform recommendation, summarised from section 7 and notes 74–77. The comparison concerns the provisions actually examined.

Two distinct records must therefore be preserved: the housing-finance legislation culminating in Act XLVI of 2026, and the Commission's recommendation for a court-connected alternative dispute resolution framework under proposed section 10A. The enacted section 15A is not devoid of settlement arrangements. Its subsection (2) proviso requires consideration of a mortgagor's written pre-sale request and provides for rescheduling, restructuring or settlement, with suspension or withdrawal of notices where an arrangement is agreed, subject to compliance. That procedure differs from the proposed section 10A mechanism. The comparison should inform the question whether further legislation is needed and how the procedures would interact. The Ministry's posted consolidation incorporating this Act also proceeds from section 10 to section 11 without section 10A. These records support the distinction; an exhaustive search for other or later amendments remains separate.[76]

The housing-finance process supplies a concrete legal comparator rather than proof that the reform recommendation has already been adopted. The next enquiry is whether the proposed court-connected procedure would fill a different need, duplicate an existing route or create conflicts of timing and remedy. A current parent-text and subsequent-amendment check remains necessary before settling legislative wording.

[76] Financial Institutions (Recovery of Finances) (Amendment) Act 2026, Act XLVI of 2026, section 3, inserted section 15A(2) proviso, Gazette of Pakistan, Extraordinary, Part I, 17 August 2026, 855; Financial Institutions (Recovery of Finances) Ordinance 2001, sections 10–11 and 15A, Pakistan Code posted consolidation incorporating Act XLVI of 2026, PDF 9–10 and following. The Gazette provision concerns the mortgagor's pre-sale written request, its disposal within thirty days and an agreed rescheduling, restructuring or settlement arrangement. Official Gazette; Pakistan Code consolidation.

Box 1. Preliminary competence and route questions

The proposed section 10A would amend the Financial Institutions (Recovery of Finances) Ordinance 2001. Before a drafting instruction is settled, the legal reviewer should verify the current parent text and subsequent amendments, compare the proposal with the enacted section 15A procedure, determine constitutional competence and the legislative route, and identify the lead Division under the actual allocation of business. Expenditure implications alone do not determine Money Bill status. Referral powers, court supervision, consent and restrictions on challenge require examination together with the remedies that remain. The preparation and scrutiny responsibilities follow the constitutional route in note 1, the allocation and procedure in notes 2–3 and 6, and the proposal and enactment records in notes 74–77. An administrative experiment cannot supply a statutory power.

Referral, consent and the means of settlement

The proposed mandatory-referral threshold concerns **principal finance availed of 50 million Pakistani rupees (PKR) or more**, rather than simply outstanding debt. Referral follows a timely leave-to-defend application and any replication; allegations of fraud, forgery or wilful default require a reasoned judicial finding of settlement possibility. The draft provides a tripartite committee, court supervision, consensual alternatives, a 60-day period with a limited extension, settlement decrees and restrictions on appeal or revision against agreed decrees.[77] These are the terms proposed for examination.

The threshold selects a class of dispute. Its justification therefore depends upon whether that class is suited to settlement, and not solely upon the amount associated with it. Case-level information about dispute types, delay and existing settlements would permit comparison with consent-based referral and case-specific judicial assessment. Aggregate pendency cannot perform that comparison.

A settlement also raises a question about the conditions under which agreement is obtained. Access to advice, bargaining resources, fees, panel conflicts and the place of proceedings may affect a party's practical ability to refuse a proposed resolution. A restriction upon challenge makes the examination of consent more important. The legal reviewer should determine what remedies would remain for coercion, misrepresentation or defective agreement, rather than treat the description of a decree as consensual as the end of the question.

The institution charged with providing settlement must possess the means to do so. Qualified panel members, staff, records and suitable facilities cannot be supplied by a statutory time limit. The design must identify who provides them, what happens during their absence, and how an unsuccessful reference returns to adjudication. Commencement and transition should preserve proceedings while the necessary arrangements are made.

Cost and time also require examination over the complete dispute. A settlement may conclude one reference while leaving enforcement unresolved. An unsuccessful reference may add a stage without shortening the suit. Public administrative expenditure, professional fees, party expenses and subsequent enforcement belong in the same assessment. The object is an accessible and effective resolution, not a settlement count detached from what the parties must do afterwards.

These are questions about the proposed design, not findings that the suggested failures have occurred.

[77] LJCP, *Law Reform Report No 139* (n 74) 6–10, proposed s 10A(1)–(2), (11)–(13) and (17).

Evolutionary intelligence preserves the separate legislative histories and provides for the design to change when experience warrants it. Strategic intelligence identifies the lawful actors, available options and practical means. Anticipatory intelligence tests the effect of unavailable services, unequal resources and incentives.

The available courses

A

Support substantially as drafted would give the recommendation a clear path towards a statutory settlement process. Its justification depends upon the selected cases, safeguards and delivery arrangements. The evidence examined for this paper does not yet support an unqualified recommendation to adopt its threshold and restrictions upon challenge.

B

Revise and stage the proposal would settle those choices before introduction or operation. Consent, review, panel independence, costs and transition would be considered together, with any phased introduction tied to objective readiness. The necessary legal authority must accompany any compulsory power or altered remedy; an administrative experiment cannot supply it.

C

Improve information and voluntary settlement support within verified existing powers would establish a baseline and test practical demand. This course may permit useful preparation before a wider statutory framework is settled. Its scope depends upon what those existing powers actually allow, and it cannot assume the legal effects sought through the proposed section.

The recommended course is targeted legal-status and evidence work, followed by a revised design where the findings support it. A bounded preparatory programme under existing powers may proceed where legally available. The strongest objection is delay: further examination could postpone a useful response to pending disputes. That objection calls for a defined timetable and focused evidence requests, rather than either indefinite study or adoption of a threshold for which the necessary case has not been made.

Responsibility for preparation and scrutiny

The lead subject Division must first be identified under the actual allocation of business. A disputed allocation would require resolution through the prescribed Cabinet Division route; the fact that a Bill is to enter Parliament does not make Parliamentary Affairs the owner of its substantive policy. The record should then distinguish the responsible Division's proposal, Law and Justice's drafting and competence advice, the prescribed Cabinet and Prime Ministerial decisions, and the Minister-in-charge's statement of objects and reasons.

Parliamentary Affairs would receive the cleared Bill through the prescribed route and connect it with government parliamentary business. Introduction belongs to the Minister-in-charge, or another Minister acting on that Minister's behalf, as the rules provide. The dossier should then follow the actual committee referral, report, House amendments and assent record. An executive timetable supplies none of those events in advance. If implementation later gives rise to an assurance, the responsible Division's undertaking and evidence of fulfilment should remain separate from Parliamentary Affairs' follow-up and the committee's assessment.

A committee research lead could assemble the chronology, comparative text and questions requiring evidence. A designated legal reviewer would resolve current law, competence, procedure and remedies. Fiscal analysis would use authorised

court and departmental information to establish staff and facility assumptions. The sponsoring committee or institution would then decide what recommendation to advance through its own procedure. Independent researchers can supply analysis of these questions without performing the official approvals.

The drafting instruction follows from the decisions. It should identify the exact current provision, the selected referral and consent model, appointment and conflict rules, legal effect and challenge, time limits, return to adjudication, administration, funding and continuity. It should distinguish Law and Justice Commission of Pakistan wording from any later proposed revision. Until the current law is verified, the immediate drafting deliverable is a clause issues schedule.

The evidence by which the proposal should be judged

The banking-court pendency data in Annex A to the Commission's report provide context. They do not identify the potentially eligible disputes or demonstrate the effect of alternative dispute resolution. Their aggregate totals also require reconciliation with the recorded adjustment categories before they are used in modelling.[78] No saving or reduction in pending cases is assumed here.

The evidence sought should include case duration, reasons for adjournment, existing settlement practices, representation and party costs. A later evaluation would follow references through settlement or return to suit, and through subsequent compliance or enforcement. Total elapsed time, failed-reference delay, public and party costs and access to advice would be examined across sufficiently similar cases, with selection effects disclosed. Negotiation content should remain protected while approved aggregate reporting permits scrutiny of cost, delay and unequal access.

A revised legislative proposal would be ready to advance when its legal basis is verified, its principal choices have reasons, its delivery responsibilities and resource assumptions are identified, and its review arrangements are workable. Evidence may instead favour the narrower course. That would be a result of the enquiry, not a failure to produce enough drafting.

08 / THE ENQUIRY

Digital public power and institutional continuity

The legal allocation before the platform

The Digital Nation Pakistan Act 2025 supplies an existing institutional structure. The National Digital Commission approves the Masterplan and implementation plans; the Pakistan Digital Authority develops, implements and monitors the programme. Section 8(g) requires avoidance of overlap with other regulators and conflict with relevant law, while section 8(h) preserves designated custodians' control and responsibility over their datasets. Rules, regulations and delegated powers have their own statutory routes.[79] The legislative question is not simply whether institutions can share an interface. It is whether the arrangement preserves the authority to make the decision carried through it.

The distinction has practical consequences. A common exchange may transmit a provincial licence without becoming the licensing authority. An

[78] LJCP, *Law Reform Report No 139* (n 74) annex A, 22–23, including the adjustment note.

[79] Digital Nation Pakistan Act 2025 (Act I of 2025), Gazette of Pakistan, Extraordinary, 29 January 2025, ss 5(a), 8(a)–(h), 11 and 24–28. The original Gazette was inspected; later implementation and sectoral permissions require their own instruments.

identity service may authenticate an applicant without deciding entitlement to a benefit. Parliamentary scrutiny should be able to identify the lawful service owner, data custodian, platform operator, reviewer and institution responsible for correction. The provincial routes examined in section 4 remain necessary: participation in a national programme is not by itself the legal act needed to transfer a function.

The same discipline applies to sectoral digital programmes. Because section 8(g) requires the Authority to avoid overlap with other regulators and section 8(h) preserves custodians' control over their datasets (see note 79), a programme serving a regulated sector, such as digital assets, would leave the competent sectoral institutions with their respective statutory decisions. This paper proposes that any such programme be examined through a legal allocation table, evidence baseline and implementation register distinguishing approval, funding, procurement, operation, evaluation and scaling.

Those institutions are already established by law. The Pakistan Virtual Assets Regulatory Authority (PVARA) now rests on the Virtual Assets Act 2026, which saves action taken under the lapsed Virtual Assets Ordinance 2025. The Act vests virtual-asset regulation primarily in PVARA "in coordination with other relevant regulators where applicable", places the Governor of the State Bank and the Chairpersons of the Securities and Exchange Commission and the Pakistan Digital Authority on its board, and requires it to share supervisory and enforcement information with the State Bank, the Commission, the Financial Monitoring Unit, the Federal Investigation Agency and the Federal Board of Revenue.[80] The State Bank of Pakistan (SBP) operates and oversees payment systems and licenses and supervises banks; the Securities and Exchange Commission of Pakistan (SECP) regulates the issue of securities and securities markets; and the Federal Board of Revenue is responsible for tax administration.[81] Identity and authentication remain with the National Database and Registration Authority, whose Ordinance requires regulations securing the confidentiality of its databases.[82] Audit of bodies established by the Federation, including the Pakistan Digital Authority and NADRA, falls to the Auditor-General.[83] Personal data has no dedicated regulator. No federal data-protection statute has been enacted: the Ministry of Information Technology and Telecommunication lists its Personal Data Protection Bill as a draft of May 2023, and a 2023 private member's Bill stands withdrawn from Senate committee, although section 5(2) of the Virtual Assets Act already defers to any such law.[84] The proposed allocation table should record each of these decision points and show the data-protection gap as a gap. Founding instruments establish each institution and its functions; they do not settle the scope of any digital-assets permission, which this

[80] Virtual Assets Act 2026 (Act XIII of 2026) ss 5(2)–(3), 6, 7(1)(d)–(e) and (g), 17(1) and 74; Virtual Assets Ordinance 2025 (Ordinance VII of 2025), Gazette of Pakistan, Extraordinary, Part I, 9 July 2025, 533 (accessed 2 November 2026). Pakistan Code text; Gazette copy of the Ordinance.

[81] State Bank of Pakistan Act 1956 (Act XXXIII of 1956) s 4C(g)–(h), inserted by the State Bank of Pakistan (Amendment) Act 2022 (Act VI of 2022), Gazette of Pakistan, Extraordinary, Part I, 29 January 2022; Securities and Exchange Commission of Pakistan Act 1997 (Act XLII of 1997) ss 3 and 20(4)(a)–(b); Federal Board of Revenue Act 2007 (Act IV of 2007) ss 3 and 4(1)(a) and (c) (accessed 2 November 2026). Gazette of Act VI of 2022; SECP Act text; FBR Act text.

[82] National Database and Registration Authority Ordinance 2000 (Ordinance VIII of 2000) ss 3 and 5(1) and (4)(c)–(d) (accessed 2 November 2026). Pakistan Code text.

[83] Auditor-General's (Functions, Powers and Terms and Conditions of Service) Ordinance 2001 (Ordinance XXIII of 2001) ss 8(d) and 14 (accessed 2 November 2026). Pakistan Code text.

[84] Ministry of Information Technology and Telecommunication, 'Legislations', entry 'Personal Data Protection Bill May 2023 – Draft' (status: Draft; 1 May 2023); Senate of Pakistan, 'Bill Summary: The Personal Data Protection Bill, 2023' (Private Members' Bill introduced 13 February 2023; withdrawn from committee and disposed of under the proviso to Standing Order 2.53A); Virtual Assets Act 2026 (n 80) s 5(2) (accessed 2 November 2026). MoITT legislation register; Senate Bill record.

paper does not assert.

What the development project actually establishes

The World Bank approved Pakistan's **Digital Economy Enhancement Project** (**DEEP**) on 22 March 2024 with an original US$78 million commitment. Credit 7514-PK is denominated in yen, at JPY11,040,600,000. The latest Implementation Status and Results Report (ISR) located, dated 31 August 2026, retains a closing date of 31 July 2028. It reports US$69.16 million as the revised equivalent, zero cancellation and US$8.36 million disbursed, or 12.09 per cent. The change in dollar equivalent is not evidence of a budget cut; exchange translation is a possible explanation, not a verified causal finding. Disbursement is also not proof of accepted delivery or benefit to a citizen.[85]

The appraisal separates institutional responsibilities. Planned allocations are US$11 million to the Ministry of Information Technology and Telecommunication for policy and whole-government enablers; US$12 million each to the National Database and Registration Authority for exchange and authentication work; US$10 million to the National Information Technology Board for its service portal and redesign; US$13 million for Ignite's innovation work; US$15 million to the Board of Investment for its business portal and regulatory modernisation; and US$5 million for management. These are allocations, not actual spending. The Board of Investment work includes the inventory and streamlining of registrations, licences, certificates and other authorisations across federal, provincial and municipal tiers. Authentication design includes alternatives for people without smartphones.[86]

For legislative intelligence, the programme creates a concrete opportunity to examine a permission from its authoritative legal source through its published requirements, administrative decision and route of challenge. An inventory entry cannot repeal a requirement, and a digital approval cannot supply a power absent from the governing instrument. Nor do digital payments or verifiable credentials establish that the Digital Economy Enhancement Project has a cryptocurrency mandate. The legislative interest lies in responsibility, trusted records, access and remedy, not in an assumed authorisation to fund or regulate digital assets.

The financing arrangements assign overall responsibility to the Ministry of Information Technology and Telecommunication and specified parts to the Board of Investment and the National Database and Registration Authority; they require provincial implementation memoranda and impose personal-data and reporting conditions. The National Database and Registration Authority agreement separately addresses its implementation unit, operational manual, resources, safeguards and grievance mechanism. Its twenty-year termination provision is distinct from project closure.[87] These obligations sharpen the enquiry into continuing responsibility, but do not prove compliance, completed provincial agreements or an enforceable remedy for every affected person.

[85] World Bank, Pakistan project approval announcement (22 March 2024); Pakistan–IDA Financing Agreement, Credit 7514-PK (2024), art II, ss 2.01 and 2.08; World Bank, *Digital Economy Enhancement Project, Implementation Status and Results Report ISR08816*, sequence 5 (31 August 2026), 7. Figures are the dated report's US-dollar equivalents, not current balances or verified final expenditure.

[86] World Bank, *Digital Economy Enhancement Project, Project Appraisal Document PAD4355* (1 March 2024), 12–17, components 1(a)–(e), 2–4. Planned allocations and institutional responsibilities, not proof of operational delivery.

[87] Pakistan–IDA Financing Agreement, Credit 7514-PK (n 85), sch 2, section I.A.9–10 and project implementation arrangements; IDA–NADRA Project Agreement (April 2024), art III s 3.01 and schedule, 2, 5–8 (PDF pagination); Disbursement and Financial Information Letter (1 April 2024). The agreement's obligations do not establish compliance or completion of provincial memoranda.

Procurement and evidence of implementation

The procurement plans revised on 28 October 2026 show why a single progress label is inadequate. The National Database and Registration Authority's cloud-native infrastructure package is recorded as signed on 7 April 2026, with a US$5.2 million estimate. That estimate is not an established award price, and signature does not establish acceptance or successful delivery. The Board of Investment's regulatory-registry package is under implementation; its consultancy for the business portal's institutional, governance and legal framework, sustainability model and delivery roadmap is under review, with no actual signed-contract date populated.[88]

The institutional framework is therefore part of ongoing procurement, not a settled arrangement which this paper may announce as operational. Scrutiny should connect each package to the public function, responsible operator, accepted deliverable and recurrent obligation. Superseded or cancelled packages should not be added to current estimates as expenditure. Planned completion dates beyond the reported project closing date require reconciliation; they do not themselves extend the financing agreement.

The FY2024–25 audit opinions are now available for the Ministry of Information Technology and Telecommunication, the Board of Investment and the National Database and Registration Authority. They address financial presentation and, in the Ministry of Information Technology and Telecommunication and Board of Investment opinions, expenditure in accordance with the legal agreements. They do not certify privacy, cybersecurity, delivery quality or effective remedies. The disclosed files do not contain the substantive management-letter material advertised in their contents. References to March 2029 in the Ministry of Information Technology and Telecommunication and Board of Investment material also differ from the later implementation report's July 2028 closing date.[89] The appropriate conclusion is a defined evidence gap, not either complete assurance or an allegation of failure. Award terms, acceptance tests, management responses and the controlling timetable remain necessary to an end-to-end assessment.

The August implementation report itself contains material inconsistencies. Its narrative reports 6.5 million transactions, while the table shows 650,000 under a thousands-labelled unit. The framework-adoption indicator says yes while its comment describes a draft in consultation and the narrative calls for formal adoption.[90] These should not be reconciled by silently choosing a favourable figure. A parliamentary account should request the indicator definition, reporting period, validated value and formal adoption record before treating the result as established. Procurement, finance, service operation and legal adoption need separate evidence.

[88] World Bank STEP procurement plans for P174402, revised 28 October 2026: NADRA, document 40136197, 6 (PDF pagination), package PK-NADRA-487456-GO-RFP; BOI, document 40136196, 6 (PDF pagination), packages PK-BOI-542104-GO-RFP and PK-BOI-540618-CS-QCBS. Estimates, actual amounts, planned dates and recorded status are not interchangeable.

[89] Auditor-General of Pakistan, DEEP FY2024–25 disclosed financial audit files: NADRA, document 40085037, opinion signed 18 December 2025, 13 (PDF pagination); MoITT, document 40085040, and BOI, document 40085038, opinions signed 23 December 2025, 7 (PDF pagination) in each. These files were disclosed in February 2026. Their advertised substantive management-letter sections were not present in the disclosed PDFs; financial opinions do not establish delivery or privacy assurance.

[90] World Bank, *DEEP Implementation Status and Results Report ISR08816* (n 85) 2 and 4. The report contains a narrative/table transaction discrepancy and a framework-adoption inconsistency. No corrected value or formal adoption record is inferred.

Identity, access and effective correction

The appraisal assigns exchange and authentication work to the National Database and Registration Authority, while section 8(h) of the Digital Nation Pakistan Act preserves designated custodians' control and responsibility over their datasets (see notes 79 and 86). Authentication is therefore not entitlement. This paper proposes that a service record distinguish registration, verification, authentication, authorisation and entitlement, and explain which failed. A mistaken source record, failed biometric match, revoked credential and adverse entitlement decision call for different responsible institutions and different remedies. Successful authentication alone cannot establish consent to a transaction or authority to perform it.

The proposed digital dossier would follow a disputed transaction through the source record, credential, exchange, service decision, reasons and challenge. It would identify who can correct each error and which dependent decisions require reconsideration. It would also test assisted and non-digital access, language and disability needs, loss of connectivity and the practical consequences of a suspended credential. Correcting the identity record should reach affected services without automatically deciding a distinct legal entitlement.

The project's environmental and social material identifies privacy, surveillance, cybersecurity and exclusion risks; its commitments include incident reporting, stakeholder engagement and a grievance mechanism.[91] Those records support scrutiny of safeguards, not a finding that safeguards have worked. Evidence access must itself remain lawful: a research dossier should use appropriately authorised or aggregated material, not collect personal records merely because a technical connection permits it. Rights and remedies require a responsible institution capable of action, not only a complaint interface.

The institution after project finance

Continuity should be settled before the financing closes. The financing agreement fixes a closing date, and the NADRA project agreement carries a separate twenty-year termination provision (see notes 85 and 87); neither date by itself settles who will operate, fund and answer for each service afterwards. This paper therefore proposes that, before closure, the responsible institutions identify a permanent operator, recurrent budget, retained staff, records and data, contractual obligations, unresolved claims and responsibility for executing remedies, together with measurable capability, procurement rights to evidence and the ability to reproduce a decision after a system changes. These are tests proposed by this paper, not findings that the Digital Economy Enhancement Project already satisfies or fails them.

The recommended enquiry is a bounded **continuity and lawful-service dossier**, prepared only with an authorised sponsor and access arrangements. It would select one service or business permission, identify the competent institutions and establish an evidence baseline. It would then test a disputed record, interrupted service, changed rule and supplier exit. The deliverable would be a reasoned allocation and transition schedule, not a new agency or an assertion that the present project should be abandoned.

Evolutionary Legal Intelligence would trace changed rules and systems, corrections and the transfer of responsibility after project closure.

[91] World Bank, *DEEP Appraisal Environmental and Social Review Summary* (June 2023), 5–7; MoITT, *DEEP Environmental and Social Commitment Plan* (January 2024), 3–8. Version-qualified risk and commitment records; template residue and inconsistent e-waste deadlines require the controlling agreed version before a compliance-date conclusion.

Strategic Legal Intelligence would examine the available powers, institutional choices and recurrent means. Anticipatory Legal Intelligence would examine exclusion, common infrastructure failure, vendor dependence and interruptions to finance or staffing. All three are needed to decide whether the existing arrangement can be made durable, needs a narrower scope or requires a legal change. The strongest alternative is to strengthen existing project controls without a separate dossier; the additional work is justified only where it exposes a consequential dependency or remedy that those controls leave unresolved.

09 / THE ENQUIRY

Participation and the duty to consider

A proposal can be legally coherent and rest upon an incomplete account of those affected. Consultation should therefore reach the choices before they are settled. This paper proposes that consultation be treated as consideration with reasons: affected groups should be heard, including those unable to participate through a professional association or online submission, and substantial objections should receive an explanation. The best-organised interest acquires no veto by being heard. The Senate's rules already provide a public-opinion procedure for Bills (see note 13), and the comparative record shows both the value of consultation placed before a committee vote and the insufficiency of a mere opportunity to submit text (see notes 59–61).

For the banking enquiry, borrowers of different sizes, guarantors, lenders, legal-aid organisations, practitioners, mediators and relevant court and regulatory officials have different information to contribute. A record dominated by institutional lenders could illuminate recovery practice while leaving the conditions faced by other parties poorly understood. The selection of contributors should follow the matters in dispute: consent, cost, independence, delay and access to adjudication.

The proposed amendment-suggestion route would allow a contributor to supply wording or describe the problem requiring a change. The instrument, provision, reasons, supporting evidence and affected interests would give the contribution a place in the enquiry. Assistance in plain language and a supported offline route would address the disadvantage of those unfamiliar with drafting or digital forms.

What follows submission matters as much as its receipt. A contribution may require clarification, combination with another proposal, or withholding because it contains confidential material, harassment or an unsupported personal allegation. Those decisions need reasons and a route to review. Disagreement with the substance should remain visible as disagreement. The final record should show which contributions changed the analysis, which were rejected and which questions remain open.

The information collected should follow that purpose. A chosen public attribution and, where needed, a private contact method will ordinarily be more appropriate than identity documents for an independent discussion. The Senate's public-petition procedure has separate official admissibility and identity requirements.[92] A contribution to the proposed independent channel would not place a matter before Parliament. Anyone choosing an official route should retain control of that distinct submission.

[92] Senate of Pakistan, 'Public Petition' (official guidance under r 277 of the Rules of Procedure and Conduct of Business in the Senate 2012, accessed 30 October 2026).

Resources, review and the capacity to correct

An institution assigned a duty may remain unable to discharge it because the financial and administrative means sit elsewhere. Fiscal assessment should therefore examine the allocation at the same time as the proposed power. Initial expenditure, recurrent operations, compliance costs, revenue effects and transition may fall upon different bodies or people. Their source, unit, baseline and assumptions should be visible, so that the reader can distinguish a forecast from the authority to spend.

The constitutional financial procedure supplies the legal foundation. Connecting it with a proportionate assessment of the proposed measure is a recommendation of this paper.[93] This paper also proposes following the chain after expenditure: finding, explanation, corrective decision and implementation. The project record shows why. The disclosed audit opinions address financial presentation and, in two cases, expenditure in accordance with the legal agreements, but the advertised management-letter material is absent, so the explanation and correction stages cannot be traced from those files (see note 89). The Government Assurances Committee and Punjab's rule 154(5) action reports already supply procedural points at which a response can be followed (see notes 4 and 33). An audit observation may identify a matter requiring examination without establishing fraud; an administrative closure may dispose of the observation without repairing the weakness which produced it. The dossier should record which stage has actually been reached.

Australia's Robodebt Royal Commission provides a caution from administrative automation. Its recommendations distinguish legality from expenditure authority, address legal advice and costing assumptions, and provide for review paths, disclosure and scrutiny of automated decision systems.[94] The relevance lies in the allocation of those responsibilities before an operational model is relied upon. The inquiry supplies evidence of governance needs; this paper does not treat its recommendations as verified implementation or as a parliamentary-intelligence deployment.

The digital enquiry adds a further resource discipline. Commitment, translated financing value, advances, actual expenditure, contractual acceptance and public benefit should occupy separate fields. A favourable financial opinion cannot replace an examination of an unavailable service or an ineffective correction. The continuity schedule proposed in section 8 should identify the competent body for recurrent appropriations and staffing, test usable transfer of records and preserve pending claims; it does not imply that project finance must be replaced by a new permanent agency.

A reviewed output consequently requires identifiable professional judgments. The source editor examines the record and locator; the legal reviewer examines status, competence and material legal propositions; fiscal expertise tests assumptions which affect the recommendation; and an accountable editor decides whether the work is ready for circulation. In a small team, one person may perform several functions. The record should disclose that combination, and a high-consequence conclusion should receive a second examination by someone who did not produce it.

Review must be capable of encountering the difficult case. Repealed provisions, changed commencement dates, similarly titled instruments,

[93] Constitution of the Islamic Republic of Pakistan 1973, arts 80–84.

[94] Royal Commission into the Robodebt Scheme, *Report* (7 July 2023, corrected 11 July 2023) recommendations 15.1–15.6 and 17.1–17.2.

inconsistent language versions, missing pages and contested interpretations test whether the service can distinguish a plausible answer from an applicable one. Where an error affects a material premise, reliance on the conclusion should be suspended and the dependent analysis reconsidered. A correction which never reaches the decision-maker leaves the defect operative.

The record also has limits of access. A public source does not make the research question or professional instruction public. Confidential submissions and non-public material require authority for external processing or disclosure. A connection between enquiries supplies no independent reason to move confidential information between them.

Delegated legislation introduces a further allocation to examine: the parent law, lawful maker, limits, publication, commencement and scrutiny route. Existing rules already reach it: Punjab's rule 154(5) and Sindh's rule 167 extend committee examination to delegated legislation, and the Digital Nation Pakistan Act prescribes its own routes for rules, regulations and delegated powers (see notes 33, 38 and 79). This paper proposes scrutiny proportionate to the significance of the delegated choice, with express treatment of transition and sunsets. The effect of a particular instrument or response must nevertheless be traced to its governing law. A committee's criticism, a recommendation for amendment and an instrument's annulment are different events.

Statute and rule mapping should accordingly begin with the enabling provision, not with similarity of titles. A related instrument may amend, commence, prescribe under, exempt from or implement another instrument; those relationships should be recorded separately, with the exact source supporting each. Rules, regulations, orders, notifications and statutory regulatory orders require their own legal character and route to be established. A circular or administrative instruction should not acquire legislative force merely because it appears in the same search result. The fiscal record should also distinguish a power to act from the appropriation, sanction and recurrent resources needed to carry it out.

11 / THE ENQUIRY

What would establish the value of the work

The enquiry begins with usable legislative judgment and should be evaluated by returning to it. Can the reader establish the correct source and version? Does the analysis expose the competence, rights, alternatives and delivery dependencies which bear upon the choice? Can another person reconstruct the reasoning and challenge its premise? Has a contribution changed a question, a draft, scrutiny or follow-up in a way which can be identified?

This paper has not established a national quantitative baseline of parliamentary research capacity. Its diagnosis rests on constitutional and institutional analysis; the task-level pilot baseline proposed here would not by itself establish a national measure. Before claiming improvement, the participating institution should record how the selected tasks are presently performed, where errors occur, how long review takes and which requests remain unmet. Comparison after the pilot should use sufficiently similar tasks and disclose the sample. Wider claims cannot be drawn from the enthusiasm of a few early users.

The distribution of assistance also belongs in the evaluation. Access confined to government or leadership could improve preparation while leaving the capacity to contest it unchanged. Government, opposition, committees and private members should be considered in the design of access, subject to the institution's lawful arrangements and

available resources. Whether the professional function can record unwelcome evidence is part of its usefulness.

Evidence for evaluation

The proposed evaluation should examine six connected matters. **Source integrity** concerns citation and version accuracy, unresolved records and the correction of errors. **Analytical quality** concerns competence, alternatives, rights, costs and delivery dependencies. **Usability** concerns whether intended readers can find the record and reconstruct the reasons. **Participation** concerns accessibility, affected perspectives, moderation and reasoned treatment of contributions. **Institutional effect** concerns identifiable changes to questions, drafts, scrutiny and follow-up. **Sustainability** concerns staff effort, recurring verification, maintenance, correction and the ability to retain and transfer the record. Measures and comparisons should follow the selected tasks and baseline; the paper supplies no invented target for improvement.

For the digital dossier, the baseline should also specify each indicator's unit, population, period and validation method. A successfully completed transaction should be distinguished from a corrected error, a resolved grievance and an implemented remedy. A migration test should show that another authorised operator can understand the records and reconstruct a past decision. Accessibility testing should include affected users and failed or interrupted journeys. None of these tests should be represented as an achieved result before it is performed.

A reading test should ask users to find a named section, identify the version read, reach its enabling or subordinate instrument and return without losing context. It should include a similarly titled amendment, an uncommenced provision, a repealed instrument and a schedule. Download checks should confirm that the text and identifiers correspond to the reader. Success should be judged by accurate retrieval and understanding of the record, not by the number of search results or the fluency of a generated explanation.

A standards claim requires a similarly bounded record: exact profile and schema versions, document classes, languages, validation method, responsible reviewer and declared exclusions. The initial sample should include an Act, amendment instrument, subordinate instrument and bilingual pair where available, testing commencement and amendment relationships rather than only whether XML parses. Source preservation, accessible presentation, legal interpretation and rule execution should be evaluated separately.

A decision-model test requires a separate set of cases: a satisfied condition, an unmet condition, missing or disputed evidence, an applicable exception, a change of law across time and a question reserved for judgment. Each outcome should expose the provisions and facts used, the model version and the point at which a responsible person must decide. A corrected source should trigger examination of dependent mappings and earlier conclusions. This tests whether the programme can recover from error, rather than only produce an answer under favourable conditions.

For substantive circulation, a material legal proposition should resolve to an identified source and passage, or disclose the precise uncertainty and its consequence for the recommendation. The output should identify its reviewer, distinguish proposed wording from current law and carry its draft or release status. Confidential material requires authority for the intended disclosure. Where a material premise fails, reliance on the affected conclusion should be suspended and dependent outputs reconsidered; recipients who may rely on the error should receive the correction.

An institution adopting the enquiry should also

settle who may ask for it. The proposed arrangement would provide an intelligible request route for government and opposition members, committees and private members within the House's lawful procedures and available capacity. Requests would identify the provision or problem, the decision and its timing. A decision to decline or defer should record its reason, and the designated institutional reviewer should be able to examine whether prioritisation has excluded a material perspective. Any particular minority trigger, entitlement or review procedure requires adoption by the competent institution; none is conferred by this paper.

This paper's contribution is to set out independent work in a form which others can examine. Legislative and constitutional sources allow its legal premises to be checked; fiscal enquiry tests the means of implementation; and consultation permits objections to reach the analysis. Here that takes the form of the banking-dispute dossier and the proposed digital continuity enquiry: legal records, competing courses and reasons for a proposed next step. A public institution considering it retains responsibility for its advice, procedure and decision.

The practical sequence set out below begins with a bounded enquiry and expands only where its use and maintenance are justified. It relies on authority already available: the allocations in the Rules of Business, the Houses' control of their procedure and committees, and the statutory functions of the Pakistan Institute for Parliamentary Services and the Law and Justice Commission (see notes 1, 2, 6, 7 and 19). On that basis, this paper concludes that the first steps require no constitutional amendment, and useful reform need not wait for one.

A representative institution becomes more capable when it can obtain an independent account, examine the alternative and require an explanation of what follows. Legislative intelligence should be judged by whether it supplies those means. Its development belongs to the work of making constitutional authority effective, with the capacity for scrutiny and correction held within the institutions responsible for exercising it.

ANNEX / THE ENQUIRY

Annex 1. Proposed responsibilities and sequence

The following schedule gives practical form to the argument. It begins after an authorised sponsor approves the scope and does not announce participation, expenditure or appointments by any institution. Existing services should supply the functions where their authority and capacity permit.

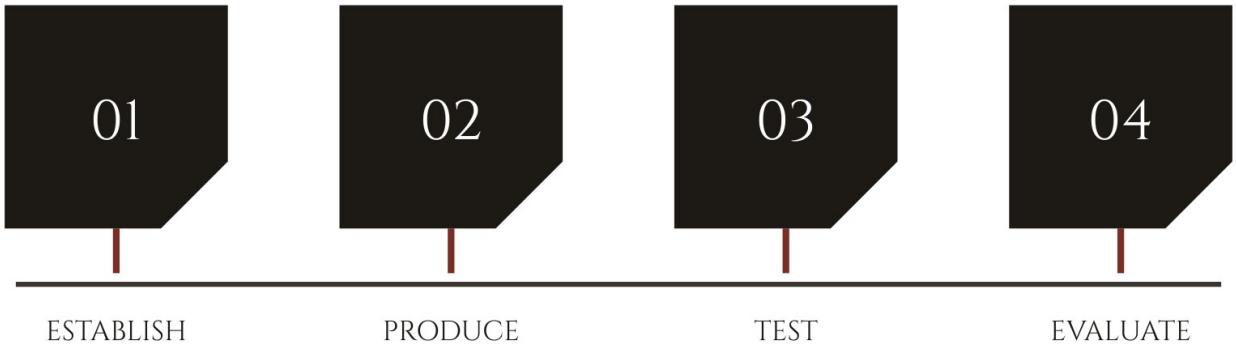


Figure 7. Establish, produce, test and evaluate. The sequence begins after approval; timings are indicative, not commitments or evidence of institutional participation.

Establish the question and the means

During approximately the first thirty days, the participating House's Secretary or designated senior official, acting through the House's authorised arrangements, would identify a professional research or committee-services lead. The Pakistan Institute for Parliamentary Services and other services would participate by agreement. The work would establish the pilot question, existing sources and services, intended users, review responsibilities and the present difficulties of performing the task. Government-side participation would require the relevant Divisions and Parliamentary Affairs to designate their own responsibilities; a House sponsor cannot appoint them by implication.

The initial result should be a verified source sample, an account of unmet demand and a baseline of task time and errors. Cooperation with Parliamentary Affairs should establish the relevant forecast, priority and follow-up records, while preserving the House's independent research and scrutiny. The sponsor should be able to identify who can request assistance, who reviews it and which capacity gaps remain. Source owners, including the Ministry of Law and Justice and the Pakistan Digital Authority where relevant, should be engaged on records and interoperability without making the parliamentary conclusion subject to executive agreement.

Complete the first enquiry

Over approximately days thirty-one to ninety, the professional lead and designated legal reviewer would complete the banking-dispute dossier, its alternatives, competence and route note, and questions for evidence. Fiscal expertise would examine material assumptions. Recorded staff effort would provide the beginning of a resource estimate.

The digital continuity enquiry is a separately authorised option, not an automatic expansion of the banking pilot. If selected, its sponsor would identify the service owner and participating project or institutional leads, secure appropriate evidence access and agree a narrow transaction to examine. Its first output would be the allocation table, source and implementation register, unresolved-evidence schedule and continuity questions. Project officials would retain implementation responsibility; the research lead would not certify compliance or direct procurement.

The dossier would be accepted for substantive circulation only when material legal propositions resolve to the cited passages, instrument status is correct, the strongest alternative has been considered and costs and missing evidence are visible. A reviewer not involved in preparing the

principal conclusion should be able to reconstruct it. Legislative wording would follow the resolution of its legal and policy premises.

Test use and participation

During approximately months four to six, a designated evaluator, separate from the principal drafter where practicable, would compare the selected tasks with the baseline. User feedback should identify not only ease of use but corrections, changed questions, neglected interests and reviewer effort. Access and usefulness should be examined across the intended institutional users.

Participation would begin only where its staffing and authority are established. Published scope, privacy and retention terms, moderation and response arrangements should precede intake. The resulting review should show how contributions were treated and how significant errors were corrected. Faster retrieval and better analysis should be reported separately.

Decide whether to continue or expand

During approximately months seven to twelve, the original sponsor would bring forward a costed choice to maintain, narrow, expand or discontinue the work through the appropriate approval route. A reviewer independent of preparation of the principal dossier conclusion should examine the evidence supporting that choice and make the review available through the House's authorised arrangements. The proposed twelve-month review should include the usefulness of the three-intelligence enquiry, the proportionality of the forms of analysis, the source descriptions and the cost of maintaining them. Failure against a measure calls for reasons: it may require better implementation, a narrower scope or redesign, rather than automatic abandonment of the method.

Continued or expanded work would require an affirmative decision through the applicable arrangements, supported by evidenced use, adequate review capacity and sustainable maintenance. An unresolved defect in legal status, confidentiality or accountable review should prevent affected new work from being released. Discontinuation should preserve authorised records and the means of notifying corrections to earlier advice.

Where procurement becomes necessary, the institution should be able to retain and export its records, annotations and review history. Documented interfaces, understandable source references, clear licences and an exit arrangement would preserve the possibility of obtaining a second opinion or changing supplier. Acceptance should test reconstruction of an earlier decision, correction of a disputed record and usable migration before dependence becomes irreversible. Any expansion should identify the continuing operator, recurrent resources and responsibility for remedies after the initial funding period.

A migration exercise should preserve provision identifiers, source files, amendment and enabling-law relationships, model versions and recorded review decisions. Exporting a readable document alone would not establish that another authorised operator can maintain the service or reconstruct a past result. A proposed supplier should therefore demonstrate both intelligible records and usable transfer before the institution depends upon a particular format or service.

The resource assumption

No budget, new post, appropriation or productivity saving is assumed. The first dossier requires research and source editing, procedural and subject expertise, institutional liaison, fiscal analysis where material and technical maintenance. Translation, accessibility and moderation require provision where offered. For the banking enquiry, recovery

proceedings and mediation are material fields of expertise.

A costed plan should record staff days, source acquisition and verification, support, training, independent review and recurring updates. Several functions may be combined, but their workload and any conflict of role should remain visible. Where essential expertise is unavailable, the scope should narrow. The cost of checking and maintaining an answer belongs in the comparison alongside the price of the service which produces it.

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